

AI-First Brand Playbook

v1.0 · April 2026 · Simplex-ity

Section 1: How to use this brand book

This document is a working system, not a reference archive. It is the single source of truth for how Simplex-ity looks, sounds, and communicates across all surfaces, for all audiences, at all stages of execution.

Who this document is for

Internal team: use this document to write copy, brief creators, review campaign concepts, set up CMS templates, and onboard new contributors. Start with Sections 4–7 for verbal identity. Go to Section 11 for visual. Go to Section 12 for AI tools.

Creators and partners: use Sections 4, 5, and 6 to understand the brand's voice and what your content should feel like when it represents Simplex-ity. Your briefing document will pull from this source.

AI tools (Claude, GPT, custom models): load the master system-prompt block from Section 12.1 at the start of every session. Use the tone matrix in Section 6 and the language register in Section 7 as operating constraints on every output. Before returning any copy, run the 25-item self-check rubric in Section 12.5. If any item scores below 1, revise before returning.

How to read this document

If you are new to the brand, read Sections 4, 5, 7, and 8 first. That sequence gives you the positioning, personality, language register, and message hierarchy: the complete verbal operating frame.

If you are writing a specific piece of copy, go directly to Section 6 (tone by surface) and Section 12.2 (per-surface prompt templates). Both are built to be used without reading the whole document first.

If you are setting up a design tool or AI system with Simplex-ity's identity, go to Section 12.7 (Claude Design setup guide). Everything you need to configure a design system is collected there.

If you remember nothing else

Every output, human-written or AI-generated, should be able to answer yes to these five tests before it ships:

1. **Trust first.** Does this copy make the brand feel more credible, not just more interesting?
2. **Curation over breadth.** Does every product, creator, and claim in this copy earn its place?
3. **Guidance, not hype.** Does this teach something or reduce a decision? Or does it just amplify?
4. **Creator as educator.** If a creator appears, do they feel like an informed guide, not a promotional channel?
5. **Technology as support.** If technology is mentioned, is it in the background, enhancing the experience without becoming the story?

These five tests are the gut-check. The rubric in Section 12.5 is the systematic version.

Section 2: Strategic anchor

Strategic anchor sentence

Simplex-ity should build a trusted, creator-guided Asian beauty business for North America, with a disciplined first phase, a makeup-led wedge, and broader platform ambition kept open without forcing later-stage complexity into the launch.

Founder brief

Founder ambition Build more than a storefront. Simplex-ity should become a trusted Asian beauty business that can grow into a broader brand, creator, and consumer platform over time.

Phase 1 posture Prove the business through disciplined retail execution first. The launch should validate trust, conversion, partner demand, and repeatable operations before heavier platform mechanics are added.

Strategic wedge Win first through makeup-led discovery, direct-brand trust, creator-guided education, and simple mobile-first shopping. Selected routine-support skincare can strengthen baskets and repeat.

Hard non-negotiables - Authenticity and direct brand relationships where commercially and operationally possible.
- Trust before breadth, inflated promises, or feature novelty. - Visible education and guidance, not decorative content. - A simple, modern, product-led experience, especially on mobile.

Explicit anti-goals - A generic discount marketplace with weak assortment control. - Cluttered discovery that feels crowded or operationally messy. - Creator activity that is hype-led or detached from teaching value. - Heavy platform complexity before commercial proof exists.

Scale conditions The following must hold under real usage before platform expansion is appropriate: - Brand and creator onboarding works in practice. - Merchandising lifts basket quality and trust. - Customers trust both product authenticity and the purchase path. - Attribution, payout logic, delivery, and service responses hold up under real usage.

Section 3: Audience and jobs-to-be-done

Audience

Tier	Definition
Primary audience	Consumers in North America, especially those shopping for Asian beauty and makeup who want more confidence, more relevance, and more practical guidance than mainstream local retail provides.
High-priority sub-segment	Asian consumers living in Western markets who want products, creators, and product education that better reflect their skin, features, beauty habits, and use cases.
Secondary audience	Asian beauty-curious consumers in North America who are not navigating the same degree of fit mismatch, but still want less noise, clearer teaching, and a more credible way into the category.
De-prioritised in phase 1	Price-first deal hunters, trend chasers looking for the fastest viral shelf, and beauty-tech seekers who expect AI diagnosis or advanced try-on to be the lead proposition.

The core consumer in plain language

The shopper Simplex-ity should serve first is, especially, an Asian consumer raised in a Western market who wants beauty products that feel more relevant to her skin tone, features, routines, and cultural beauty references than what mainstream local retail usually offers. She discovers products through creators and content, but needs to trust both the product and the retailer before she buys. She converts when the retailer reduces her guesswork: why this was selected, what it is for, how it wears, and why this is a credible place to buy.

How she behaves and what she needs

Behavior or need	Implication
Discovery starts in content, not on a retailer homepage	Copy must connect to what she already knows from creators and video; it cannot ignore that context
She looks for video swatches, texture, finish, wear time, removal, and creator fit	PDP copy must work alongside visual content, not replace it
She needs to trust both the creator and the place she is buying from	Product legitimacy and purchase-path legitimacy both matter
Local retail feels mismatched; open marketplaces feel risky	Simplex-ity wins by feeling more credible and more edited, not by being cheaper
She converts when the retailer reduces guesswork	Every surface should answer: why this was selected, for whom, how it wears
She is not simply seeking the cheapest route if standard retail gives more confidence	Trust and fit matter more than lowest price for the core segment

Jobs-to-be-done

1. Help me find products that feel relevant to me, not just popular in the abstract.

2. Help me understand how a product looks, feels, and wears on skin that is more like mine.
3. Help me move from creator inspiration to purchase without wondering whether the product or seller is legitimate.
4. Help me shop Asian beauty without the usual friction of crowded catalogues, vague copy, or cross-border uncertainty.
5. Help me build a more complete look or routine rather than forcing me to guess which products go together.

The category tension Simplex-ity is built to resolve

Today, the shopper often has to assemble the journey alone. Discovery happens on one platform, validation on another, and purchase somewhere else entirely. That creates four recurring tensions: inspiration versus safety, access versus reliability, breadth versus clarity, and algorithmic discovery versus accountable guidance. Simplex-ity should win by collapsing that fragmented journey into one more trusted, more teachable retail experience.

Section 4: Brand idea, promise, positioning

Positioning statement

Simplex-ity is a more trusted, more guided way for Western-market consumers to discover and buy Asian beauty. It combines curated assortment, creator-led teaching, and disciplined commerce design so makeup-led discovery feels less risky, more relevant, and more worth buying from.

11.5 Visual avoidances

These are not stylistic preferences. They are the conditions that cause the brand to drift away from trust and toward either noise or hard-tech, both of which directly damage the core proposition.

Avoid	Why it matters
Discount marketplace clutter	Crowded grids, excessive sale badges, price-forward layouts, and visual noise actively weaken trust and signal low editorial standards. Even a strong product loses credibility in a cluttered frame.
Hard-tech interface aesthetics	Neon UI overload, heavy futuristic effects, floating interface elements on photography, and overly clinical AI-adjacent visuals pull the brand away from beauty and toward software. The brand uses technology as a support layer, not a visual language.
AI-rendered idealised portraits	Symmetrical, smoothed, AI-generated faces undercut the authenticity the brand is built on. They also read increasingly as AI to consumers who are becoming sensitive to the difference. Do not use them on any consumer-facing surface.
Mobile-phone-as-hero with AI badges	Showing a phone screen with an AI interface as the hero visual signals “beauty-tech app,” not “trusted beauty retail.” This is the visual equivalent of leading with technology before trust.
Childish or trend-desperate styling	Meme graphics, chaotic stickers, slang-heavy visual overlays, and overly playful typography undermine the editorial position the brand has established. On-trend can read off-brand very quickly.
Generic over-retouched beauty imagery	Heavily filtered, overly smoothed, or skin-perfecting imagery feels dishonest in a brand built on authenticity and real-life wear. Aspirational and polished is right; unrecognisably altered is not.
Improper logo usage	Any of the violations listed in 11.3. Logo integrity is a basic signal of brand discipline.

11.6 Visual and verbal consistency

The visual and verbal systems should reinforce each other. The most common failure modes:

- Copy claims curation but the layout looks crowded. The layout wins. The reader does not feel curated; they feel overwhelmed.

- Copy claims authenticity but the images feature AI-generated faces. The images win. The reader does not feel trust; they feel something is off.
- Copy is warm and human but the page is cold, white, and over-engineered. The reader gets mixed signals and resolves the tension by trusting neither.

The self-check rubric in Section 12.5 includes three visual-verbal consistency checks (items 23-25). Run them on any asset where copy and image appear together.

Section 5: Brand personality and voice principles

Personality

Simplex-ity should feel elevated, calming, credible, contemporary, curated, and clear. Feminine without becoming overly precious. Modern without becoming clinical.

The brand should not feel like a trend machine, a discount platform, or an algorithm. It should feel like a knowledgeable friend who has done the curation for you and genuinely wants you to find the right thing.

Personality spectrum

More this	Than this
Guide	Guru
Curator	Entertainer
Thoughtful	Loud
Refined	Trendy
Confident	Salesy

These are not absolutes; they are a direction. When copy or creative feels like it is sliding toward the right column, it should be pulled back.

Voice principles

Principle	What it means in practice
Clear, not cluttered	Simplify without dumbing things down. Avoid stacked claims, bloated phrasing, or too many messages competing at once. One idea per sentence. One message per surface moment.
Confident, not pushy	Sound assured and selective, not aggressive or urgent. The brand should never pressure. It should present and guide.
Educated, not overexplained	Teach with taste and restraint. Give the right level of context, then stop. If the reader already knows, trust them. If they need context, give it once, clearly.
Warm, not sugary	Feel welcoming and human without sounding childish or breathless. Warmth comes from usefulness, not exclamation marks.
Curated, not crowded	Imply discernment. Not everything belongs. Copy should feel selective, even when it is describing a broad collection.
Modern, not robotic	Technology can support the experience, but beauty should remain the lead story. Let the brand feel human.

Section 6: Tone by surface

Every surface has a tone direction and two example sentences: one "hero" (the primary copy moment) and one "supporting" (the secondary or contextual layer). Example sentences are illustrative; they show register, not final copy.

Flex rules: Always clear. Always trust-building. Flex on warmth, formality, and length by surface.

Surface	Tone direction	Hero example	Supporting example
Homepage	Clear, polished, lightly aspirational. Trust first, then guidance, then discovery.	"Discover Asian beauty with more confidence, from a curated makeup-led assortment shaped for real-life wear, explained by creators who know how it actually performs."	"Simplex-ity brings together trusted products, creator-led guidance, and a more credible path from inspiration to purchase."
PDP (product page)	Practical, informed, encouraging. Explain why it was selected, how it wears, who it suits.	"Chosen for finish, wear, and real-life use. See why it made the edit, how it looks on different skin, and how creators actually use it."	"A soft-matte lip formula that wears comfortably through the day and works especially well when you want definition without heaviness."
Creator brief	Elevated, collaborative, credible. Teach first, translate fit and use case, keep the tone calm.	"Your job is to make the product easier to understand, easier to picture on real skin, and easier to trust. Show the routine, the finish, and the wear."	"We partner with creators who genuinely use, love, and teach with Asian beauty. Not creators who hype without backing, reasoning, or real product experience."
Service reply	Calm, direct, human, trust-repairing. No deflection. No scripted warmth.	"We've looked into this and your order left our warehouse on [date] with [carrier]. Here's your tracking link and what to expect. If anything seems off, reply here and we'll sort it."	"We're sorry this wasn't what you expected. Tell us what happened and we'll make it right."
Social (IG + TikTok captions)	IG: editorial, purposeful, confident: the caption adds the useful or trust layer beneath the visual. TikTok: hook-first, slightly more casual, still on-brand and never trend-chasing.	IG: "Why this made the edit: buildable coverage that doesn't settle into pores. Shot in natural light, no filter."	TikTok: "Most people skip this step. Here's why it matters for glass skin."
Email (subject + body)	Trusted editor tone. Subject lines: intriguing, no false urgency, no all-caps. Body: one clear focus, educational where relevant, not a catalogue push.	Subject: "Three products that work better together." Body: "We've been using this three-step routine for the past month. Honestly, it replaces the ten-step routine no one has time for. Here's what it is and why it works."	Subject: "The one shade you need this summer." Body: "We haven't seen anything like this formula. It's the first fluffy dewy blush that applies on wet but dries matte. Check out the swatches and the full try-on video."
Error / empty states	Calm, honest, helpful. No false cheer. No brand jargon when something breaks. Direct, with a clear next step.	Search empty state: "Nothing matched that search. Try a texture, finish, or brand name instead."	Cart empty: "Your cart's empty. Start with a look or browse the current edit." Error 404: "This page isn't here. Head back to the shop or search for what you're looking for."
Investor-facing	Data-anchored, commercially specific, confident. No lifestyle hyperbole. Brand discipline signals to investors that the team will not over-promise to consumers either.	"Phase 1 validates trust and conversion mechanics through a makeup-led, curated assortment with creator-guided discovery, before platform complexity is added."	"The brand earns consumer trust through editorial curation and creator teaching, not influencer breadth. That discipline is the commercial foundation, not a constraint."
Partner-facing (creator + brand)	Collaborative, peer tone. Clear about what Simplex-ity asks and why. Sets honest expectations. Credibility and selectivity signal that Simplex-ity is worth partnering with.	"We're building a more trusted, more guided way to shop Asian beauty for Western-market consumers. We're looking for partners who value teaching, credibility, and a more selective retail experience."	"The relationship is built on usefulness and earned credibility, not follower count or promotional throughput."

Section 7: Language register

Use this table as an active drafting check, not a one-time read. Copy that is sliding into the "avoid" column is usually the fastest sign that brand trust is eroding.

Lean into	Use with care	Avoid
Trusted	Innovative: only with a specific claim, not as a vibe word	One-stop shop
Curated	Transformative: same rule	Hottest picks
Guided	Community: only when referring to a real, specific group, not as a warmth signal	Must-have deals
Selected	Premium: acceptable in brand storytelling; loses meaning as a product descriptor without context	Beauty hacks
Authentic	Personalized: only when a real feature or editorial logic backs it	Trendiest products
Elevated	AI-powered: only when a real function backs it; never as a positioning lead	Disrupt
Thoughtful	Exclusive: only for genuine launch moments, not as general assortment language	Revolutionize
Creator-led		Cutting-edge innovation
Tailored		Game-changer
Confidence		Best prices everywhere
Clear		All your beauty needs
Finish		Viral beauty destination
Wear		AI-powered personalisation (when unproven)
Routine		Community-loved (when not specific)
Discovery		Creator-approved (when not specific)
Relevant		Fastest shipping (without operational proof)
Direct from brands		Authorization or no-split-shipment claims (without ops proof)
Why it was selected		Medical, clinical, dermatological, or efficacy-adjacent language
Real-life use		Works for everyone
Informed		False urgency or fake scarcity

The test for "use with care" words: Ask whether a specific, verifiable claim backs the word. If yes, it is usable. If the word is doing emotional work that a fact should be doing, replace it with the fact.

Punctuation rules

No em dashes. Em dashes (the "—" character) are prohibited in all Simplex-ity brand copy, whether written by a human or generated by an AI tool. They introduce a visual and tonal register that conflicts with the brand's clarity and directness principles.

When you are tempted to use an em dash, make a structural choice instead:

- If you are introducing a consequence or explanation, use a colon.
- If you are adding a parenthetical, use commas.
- If you are joining two independent clauses, use a semicolon or split into two sentences.
- If the sentence only works with an em dash, rewrite it. The dash is usually a sign the sentence is doing too much at once.

For AI tools: this prohibition is explicit. Do not use em dashes in any output generated on behalf of Simplex-ity. If a prompt template or example in this document uses an em dash, treat it as an error and do not replicate it.

Section 8: Messaging hierarchy and trust signals

Message hierarchy

Every piece of brand copy should prioritise messages in this order. If a piece of copy skips trust and leads with desirability or technology, it is out of hierarchy.

Priority	Pillar	Role	What it should communicate
1	Trust	Remove fear	Credible retail control, selection logic, calm presentation, and claims that feel earned rather than decorative. The consumer should feel that the product and the place she is buying from are both legitimate.
2	Guidance	Reduce guesswork	Relevant creators, plain-language teaching, real-life wear explanation, and confidence at the point of choice. The consumer should understand what to try and how to use it.
3	Desirability	Make the category personally usable and worth exploring	Products and looks that feel aligned with real needs. Editorial curation that feels beautiful and worth trying. Not aspirational in a way that creates distance.
4	Technology	Enhance, never dominate	Technology should feel like a tool in the background: helpful, not the story. Never let it become the brand's lead claim.

Trust signals

Trust is the most important brand job. It cannot remain a vague promise; it has to show up explicitly and repeatedly across surfaces.

Signal	How it should show up	What not to overstate
Authenticity and sourcing clarity	Make it clear that products come from trusted brand relationships, authorized distribution, or direct sourcing pathways wherever applicable. Do not make broad authorization claims until operations can support them.	Do not claim exclusive authorization without sourcing documentation in place.
Why this product was selected	Do not just show products. Explain the logic behind selection: creator expertise, routine fit, finish, skin need, or use case. The edit should feel chosen, not assembled by algorithm.	Do not imply expert curation where the selection logic is thin or commercial.
Creator credibility	Creators should feel like informed guides, not generic influencers. Their authority should come from usefulness, consistency, and beauty fluency, not follower count.	Do not describe a creator as "trusted" or "credible" without showing what makes them so.
Product education	Consumers should quickly understand what a product does, who it is for, how it wears, and how to use it. This is not optional copy. It is the trust mechanic.	Do not make efficacy or outcome claims ("this will clear your skin") unless backed by evidence.
Recommendation transparency	When recommendations are personalized or creator-led, the basis should feel understandable, not mysterious. "Recommended by [creator] for [use case]" beats "handpicked for you."	Do not use algorithmic personalisation language if no real personalization feature is active.
Quality of experience	A calm, considered visual system builds trust. Messy merchandising weakens it. The design and copy work together.	Do not let the visual system contradict the trust signals the copy is building.

Trust signals: what to never overstate

Avoid medical or clinical claims without evidence. Avoid universal claims ("works for everyone"). Avoid exaggerated outcome promises. Avoid false urgency or fake scarcity language. These are not stylistic preferences; they are the proof-discipline rules that protect both the consumer and the business. The full proof-discipline framework is in Section 9.

Section 9: Proof and claims discipline

This section protects Simplex-ity from over-promising. It defines what can be said now, what needs operational proof first, and what should never be said at all. Treat this section as load-bearing for launch copy.

What we can say, and what it needs behind it

Proof point	What the consumer should feel	Current basis	Claim discipline
Curated with intent	I am not being asked to sort through noise.	Focused assortment logic; phase 1 scope discipline.	Safe to use when the edit is real and visibly selective.
Guided by relevant creators	I can see how this looks, wears, and fits in a routine that makes sense for me.	Creator role and the need for creators as trust bridges.	Safe to use when creator selection and briefing are genuinely governed.
More credible place to buy	This retailer feels more trustworthy than fragmented marketplace alternatives.	Curated retail model and phase 1 trust priority.	Only use stronger authenticity language once sourcing and authorization language are operationally ready.
Built for decision confidence	The site helps me choose, not just browse.	Guidance priority and the need to reduce choice paralysis.	Safe to use when PDPs and discovery flows visibly explain why products belong.
Routine-aware, not SKU-only	I can build a look more easily because the products are connected for me.	Makeup plus support-skincare thesis and routine-based merchandising logic.	Safe to use when edits, bundles, or linked routines are actually merchandised.

Hard rules: these apply without exception

- **No medical, clinical, dermatological, or efficacy-adjacent claims** unless the product carries substantiated evidence. "This will clear your skin" is not a brand voice question; it is a liability question.
- **No "works for everyone"** or equivalents. This brand is built on relevance and fit; universal claims undermine the core proposition.
- **No false urgency or fake scarcity** ("Only 3 left!", "Offer ends midnight!") unless the scarcity is real and the deadline is genuine.
- **No authorization, sourcing, or fulfillment claims** (e.g., "100% authentic direct from Korea", "guaranteed no split shipment") unless operations can prove them. These claims, if false, destroy exactly the trust the brand is built to earn.

Copy that requires human review before publishing regardless of rubric score is listed in Section 12.6.

Common objections and how to respond

Objection	Response logic	What must prove it
Can I trust this product and this retailer?	Lead with control, clarity, and visible retail standards. Make it clear that selection is deliberate and the purchase path is more credible than a marketplace free-for-all.	Sourcing language, authenticity standards, retailer-of-record clarity, trust page, and disciplined merchandising.
How do I know this will suit me?	Show how the product looks and wears on relevant skin. Explain finish and feel in plain language. Use creators as translators, not promoters.	Video content, creator proof, PDP modules: "how it wears", "why it made the edit", "best for".
Why buy here instead of YesStyle, Amazon, Sephora, or Olive Young?	Position Simplex-ity as the edited, more confidence-building choice: less noise than marketplaces, more relevant guidance than generic retail, a calmer route from discovery to purchase.	Sharper assortment, stronger use-case explanation, clear creator role, a visibly selective consumer experience.
What if shipping or returns become a hassle?	Do not overpromise. Emphasise predictability, clarity, and support. Reduce fear upfront through better guidance and fit explanation.	Service policy, delivery promise, support scripts, and operations that match the copy.

Section 10: Naming system

Naming should be simple, elegant, and easy to understand. Simplex-ity should not overbrand every feature or campaign with abstract invented language.

Naming rule of thumb

If a name needs explanation, it is probably too clever. Useful first, branded second.

Naming principles

Principle	Meaning
Clarity over cleverness	If the name is not immediately understandable, it is doing too much.
Desirability with restraint	Names can feel elevated, but they should not become vague luxury poetry.
Useful first, branded second	Consumers should understand what something is before they admire the name.
Keep the system coherent	Each category of thing should follow a recognisable pattern.
Avoid forced futurism	Do not create names that sound like beauty-tech jargon.

Naming rules by category

Category	Structure	Examples
Platform features	Clear descriptive names with light brand polish. Descriptor + function.	Shade Match, Skin Match, Routine Guide, Creator Picks, Smart Checkout, Try-On Studio
Product collections or edits	Simple editorial language that signals curation. Theme + Edit or Theme + Collection.	Everyday Glow Edit, Soft Matte Edit, Creator Base Collection, K-Beauty Makeup Edit, New Colours Collection
Campaigns	Editorial and elevated, not promotional or gimmicky.	Made to Match, The New Classics, First Look, Soft Focus, In Your Rotation, Learn the Look
Content series	Teachable and recurring.	How to Wear It, Creator Routine Notes, Shade School, What to Try Next, Finish Guide
Creator program	Minimal and credible.	Simplex-ity Creators, Creator Partners, Creator Edit Program

What to avoid in naming

Avoid	Why	Examples of what not to do
Overengineered tech naming	Pulls the brand toward hard-tech aesthetics and away from beauty	MirrorIQ X, GlowSync Engine, BeautyOS, SkinGPT
Hype-heavy collection or campaign names	Cheapens the brand's editorial positioning and signals desperation for attention	Ultimate Beauty Vault, Trend Drop 3.0, The Viral Shelf, Glow Up Now
Forced "community" language	Sounds manufactured; creates distance from the credibility the brand is building	Glow Squad, Simplex Babes, Elite Creator Army

Naming checklist

Before approving any name, answer these questions. A "no" to any of them should trigger a revision.

1. Is it instantly understandable without explanation?
2. Does it feel elevated without sounding vague?
3. Could it live across site, social, and creator content without adaptation?
4. Does it sound like Simplex-ity rather than a generic beauty campaign?
5. Would it still sound right in 18 months?

Section 11: Visual system

The visual system is not decoration. It is a trust mechanism. A consumer who lands on a page that feels calm, selective, and well-composed begins trusting the brand before she reads a word. Inconsistency in the visual system undermines whatever the copy is building.

This section documents the existing system as the source of truth and adds the usage discipline the current thin brand guide does not provide. It does not propose redesigns. Where tensions exist between the current assets and the brand direction, they are flagged as watch-outs for Kieran's review.

Logo image assets are referenced by description here. Extracted PNG files will be embedded in the final `.docx` and `.html` builds during Phase 7 (PDF skill extraction task).

11.1 Colour palette

The six colours below are the complete approved palette. Any colour outside this set requires explicit sign-off and should be treated as an exception, not an extension.

Swatch	Name	Hex	RGB	HSL	Role
Primary lilac	Primary brand colour	#8c82fc	rgb(140, 130, 252)	hsl(245, 95%, 75%)	Headlines, logo on white, editorial framing, primary brand moments
Accent violet	Stronger accent	#5e50fb	rgb(94, 80, 251)	hsl(245, 95%, 65%)	Emphasis, active states, calls to action, sharp editorial contrast
Soft lilac	Supporting lilac	#bab4fd	rgb(186, 180, 253)	hsl(245, 95%, 85%)	Supporting backgrounds, card fills, section framing
Lavender wash	Lightest lavender	#e8e6fe	rgb(232, 230, 254)	hsl(245, 95%, 95%)	Light section backgrounds, subtle framing, quiet separators
White canvas	Primary canvas	#ffffff	rgb(255, 255, 255)	hsl(0, 0%, 100%)	Primary page background; should carry most of every layout
Neutral grey	Quiet neutral	#e6e6e6	rgb(230, 230, 230)	hsl(0, 0%, 90%)	Borders, dividers, inactive states, quiet support elements

Body text: #1a1a1f (near-black, not pure black). Pure black (#000000) should not be used for body copy as it creates excessive contrast against white and reads harder than necessary.

Colour usage discipline

Purple as signature, not blanket wash. The primary lilac #8c82fc should lead headings, logo moments on white, and editorial framing. It should not flood layouts. When purple dominates a page, it starts reading as a software product rather than a beauty brand. White carries most of the page. Purple signals the brand.

The deeper violet #5e50fb is selective. Use it for emphasis, active UI states, and calls to action where contrast and intentionality matter. Do not use it as a fill for large surface areas.

The lighter tones support, not lead. #bab4fd and #e8e6fe work for card backgrounds, section framing, and quiet structural elements. They are not hero colours.

Off-palette colours are not permitted without explicit approval. Neon tones, warm terracottas, and any purple outside the defined family should not appear on brand surfaces.

A known tension between this palette and the beauty editorial direction is documented in Section 16 (Watch-outs for Founder Review). The three usage disciplines above are the mitigation within the current palette.

11.2 Typography

The type system uses two typefaces. Both should be available across all production environments. If either is not available for a specific output format, fallback instructions apply (see below).

Role	Typeface	Used for
Primary / identity	Exo	Headlines, section titles, slogan lines, brand statement moments
Secondary / body	Montserrat	Secondary headers, subheadings, body copy, navigation, functional copy
Body text colour	n/a	#1a1a1f for all running body copy

Type hierarchy and usage

Headlines should feel airy and editorial, not dense or compressed. Scale and spacing do the work of hierarchy; decorative styling does not. The system relies on restraint.

Exo (headlines and slogans): Use at generous scale with open tracking. Avoid condensed weights. Avoid all-caps headlines at large scale (they read aggressive, not elevated). Sentence case or title case depending on the surface; all-caps only for short labels or navigation items where convention requires it.

Montserrat (body and secondary): Use for all running copy, supporting headers, and functional UI text. Regular and medium weights for body copy. Semi-bold or bold for subheadings. Avoid excessive weight variation within a single layout. Do not introduce light or thin weights for large body text blocks as they reduce legibility at small sizes.

What to avoid:

- Introducing additional typefaces without a clear system reason and explicit approval
- Decorative effects on type (outlines, drop shadows, gradients on text)
- Compressed or condensed layouts that fight the spacious editorial feel
- Mixing Exo and Montserrat at the same weight and size within a single line (they are distinct roles, not interchangeable)

Fallback for .docx outputs: Exo 2 (Google Fonts) if Exo is not embeddable; Calibri as final fallback. Montserrat falls back to Calibri. A note should appear in the document footer if fallback fonts are in use.

A known tension between Exo's geometric-tech character and the brand's editorial direction is documented in Section 16 (Watch-outs for Founder Review), including specific alternative typefaces to evaluate at the next brand evolution.

11.3 Logo

Three logo variants are approved. Each has a defined use context. Using the wrong variant in the wrong context is one of the fastest ways to undermine the brand's visual integrity.

Variant	Use context
Full colour (primary lilac on white)	Use only on white or very light backgrounds. This is the default logo for all primary brand surfaces.
White version	Use on photography, coloured backgrounds, or dark surfaces where the full-colour version would not read clearly.
Black version	Use on white or light backgrounds where colour is not available or appropriate (e.g., single-colour print, embossed materials, some co-branding contexts).

Logo image files: Extracted from [SimplicityBrandGuidelines.pdf](#) during Phase 7. Until then, use the existing PDF as the source.

Logo usage rules

- Use the full-colour logo only on a white background. If the background is not white, switch to the white or black variant.
- Maintain clear space around the logo at all times. Do not crowd it with other elements.
- Do not place the logo directly on busy photography without clear contrast.

Logo violations

Do not do any of the following:

- Rotate the logo at any angle
- Distort or stretch the logo in any dimension
- Partially obscure the logo with other elements
- Recolour the logo outside the approved three variants
- Apply drop shadows, outlines, or effects to the logo
- Place the logo on a background colour that reduces legibility

11.4 Imagery direction

Imagery is where the brand's warmth lives. The palette and typography are cool and considered; photography brings the human, sensory, and aspirational quality the colour system cannot carry alone. Getting the imagery direction wrong is the fastest way to contradict the trust and editorial positioning the verbal identity is building.

Product still-life (primary image type)

Lead with editorial product still-life photography. This is the dominant image format for homepage hero moments, collection pages, email headers, and social feed.

Reference: Pitch deck page 8 (Beauty of Joseon still-life) is the correct reference. The qualities to replicate: styled flat-lay with silk and botanical elements, soft lavender surface, luminous and even lighting, generous white space, selective product arrangement that implies curation rather than abundance. Products feel chosen, not piled.

What to look for in product still-life:

- Soft, diffused, luminous lighting. No harsh shadows or dramatic studio lighting that reads commercial rather than editorial.
- Lavender, white, or pale neutral surfaces. Products should feel at home in the brand palette.
- Selective styling. One to three products per frame as a rule. More than five starts reading as a catalogue, not a curated edit.
- Botanical and natural texture accents (silk, linen, soft botanicals) where they support the mood. Not forced or overdone.
- Clean composition with generous negative space. The frame should breathe.

Creator portraiture (secondary image type)

Creator imagery should feel editorial, not amateur and not over-produced. The goal is credibility and warmth without the chaotic or hype-led energy of typical influencer photography.

Rules:

- Real creators, not models or AI-generated faces. The authenticity of real people is part of the trust signal.
- Editorial styling: considered clothing, clean makeup, intentional setting. Not a ring-light bedroom selfie and not a luxury fashion shoot.
- Natural skin. The brand is not built on heavy retouching or skin-perfecting filters. Creators should look like themselves.
- Soft lavender or white backdrops where possible. Busy or distracting environments should be avoided unless the setting adds clear contextual value (a creator in a meaningful space, not just any background).
- Makeup and product should be visible and legible. If a creator is demonstrating a product, the viewer should be able to see the finish, wear, and effect.

Composition principles

- **White-led pages.** Most of the layout should be white or very light. Colour and imagery are accents within that space, not the base.
- **Generous whitespace.** Crowded layouts feel like marketplaces. Spacious layouts feel like curated retail. Whitespace is not wasted space; it is a trust signal.
- **Selective emphasis.** One strong visual focus per section or screen. Do not compete for attention within a single frame.
- **Editorial hierarchy.** The visual flow of a page should guide the eye purposefully: from brand statement to product to action. Not scattered.
- **Clean structure.** Grid-aligned layouts. Avoid asymmetry for decorative reasons; use it when it adds visual purpose.

The pitch-deck visual direction conflicts with the imagery standards set in this section. The specific conflict and recommended remediation steps are documented in Section 16 (Watch-outs for Founder Review).

11.5 Visual avoidances

These are not stylistic preferences. They are the conditions that cause the brand to drift away from trust and toward either noise or hard-tech, both of which directly damage the core proposition.

Avoid	Why it matters
Discount marketplace clutter	Crowded grids, excessive sale badges, price-forward layouts, and visual noise actively weaken trust and signal low editorial standards. Even a strong product loses credibility in a cluttered frame.
Hard-tech interface aesthetics	Neon UI overload, heavy futuristic effects, floating interface elements on photography, and overly clinical AI-adjacent visuals pull the brand away from beauty and toward software. The brand uses technology as a support layer, not a visual language.
AI-rendered idealised portraits	Symmetrical, smoothed, AI-generated faces undercut the authenticity the brand is built on. They also read increasingly as AI to consumers who are becoming sensitive to the difference. Do not use them on any consumer-facing surface.
Mobile-phone-as-hero with AI badges	Showing a phone screen with an AI interface as the hero visual signals "beauty-tech app," not "trusted beauty retail." This is the visual equivalent of leading with technology before trust.
Childish or trend-desperate styling	Meme graphics, chaotic stickers, slang-heavy visual overlays, and overly playful typography undermine the editorial position the brand has established. On-trend can read off-brand very quickly.
Generic over-retouched beauty imagery	Heavily filtered, overly smoothed, or skin-perfecting imagery feels dishonest in a brand built on authenticity and real-life wear. Aspirational and polished is right; unrecognisably altered is not.
Improper logo usage	Any of the violations listed in 11.3. Logo integrity is a basic signal of brand discipline.

11.6 Visual and verbal consistency

The visual and verbal systems should reinforce each other. The most common failure modes:

- Copy claims curation but the layout looks crowded. The layout wins. The reader does not feel curated; they feel overwhelmed.
- Copy claims authenticity but the images feature AI-generated faces. The images win. The reader does not feel trust; they feel something is off.
- Copy is warm and human but the page is cold, white, and over-engineered. The reader gets mixed signals and resolves the tension by trusting neither.

The self-check rubric in Section 12.5 includes three visual-verbal consistency checks (items 23-25). Run them on any asset where copy and image appear together.

Section 12: AI operating system

This section is the machine-native layer of the brand playbook. Its purpose is to make Simplex-ity's brand identity directly ingestible by AI tools so that any AI-assisted copy output holds to the same standards as human-written copy reviewed against this document.

The section has seven components:

- 12.1 Master system-prompt block (load at session start)
- 12.2 Per-surface prompt templates (9 surfaces)
- 12.3 Image-generation style anchors (3 templates)
- 12.4 Do-not-say register (YAML, 54 entries)
- 12.5 Brand self-check rubric (25 items, prose and YAML)
- 12.6 Human-review escalation rules
- 12.7 Claude Design setup guide

12.1 Master system-prompt block

Copy the entire block below and paste it at the start of any AI session producing Simplex-ity copy. Do not summarise or paraphrase it. Load the full block.

SIMPLEX-ITY BRAND OPERATING CONTEXT

ROLE

You are writing on behalf of Simplex-ity. Your job is to produce on-brand copy that feels trusted, guided,

POSITIONING

Simplex-ity is a more trusted, more guided way for Western-market consumers to discover and buy Asian beauty.

AUDIENCE

The core consumer is a shopper in North America, particularly an Asian consumer raised in a Western market.

PERSONALITY SPECTRUM

More guide than guru.

More curator than entertainer.

More thoughtful than loud.

More refined than trendy.

More confident than salesy.

VOICE PRINCIPLES

Clear, not cluttered: simplify without dumbing down. One idea per sentence. One message per surface moment.

Confident, not pushy: sound assured and selective. The brand presents and guides; it does not pressure.

Educated, not overexplained: give the right level of context, then stop.

Warm, not sugary: welcoming and human, without exclamation marks or breathless enthusiasm.

Curated, not crowded: every word, product, and claim earns its place.

Modern, not robotic: technology supports the experience; beauty remains the lead story.

MESSAGE HIERARCHY (apply in this order)

1. Trust: make the product and the retailer feel credible.

2. Guidance: reduce guesswork. Explain what, how, and why.

3. Desirability: make the category feel relevant and worth exploring.

4. Technology: mention only as a supporting enhancement, never as the lead claim.

DO-NOT-SAY SHORTLIST (15 most critical)

one-stop shop

hottest picks

must-have

game-changer

disrupt / disruptive

viral

AI-powered (when no real feature backs it)

community-loved (when not specific and verifiable)
creator-approved (when not specific and verifiable)
clinically proven (when not substantiated)
works for everyone
don't miss out
selling out fast
transform your skin
revolutionary

PROOF DISCIPLINE

Every claim must be backed by something real. Do not say a product is authentic if sourcing cannot confirm

PUNCTUATION RULE

Do not use em dashes in any output. If a sentence requires an em dash to work, rewrite the sentence. Use a

MANDATORY SELF-CHECK

Before returning any output, score it against the 25-item Brand Self-Check Rubric in Section 12.5. If any

12.2 Per-surface prompt templates

One template per surface. Each template is a standalone brief: load the master system-prompt block first, then load the relevant surface template for the specific copy task. Do not mix surface templates in a single session without reloading.

Surface 1: Homepage

SURFACE: Homepage

PURPOSE: Create trust quickly and communicate the brand's core proposition to a first-time visitor. The ho

AUDIENCE: North American consumers arriving via creator content, search, or social. Many are first-time vi

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

1. Trust: this is a credible, curated place to buy Asian beauty.
2. Guidance: creators and curation make discovery easier and more confident.
3. Desirability: elevated beauty worth exploring.

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Why products were selected (selection logic, not just inventory)
- Quality of experience (calm, selective, considered presentation)

TONE ANCHOR: Clear, polished, lightly aspirational. Trust first, then guidance, then discovery.

LENGTH:

- Hero headline: 5-10 words
- Supporting copy: 25-50 words
- Primary CTA: 3-6 words

MANDATORY FIELDS: Hero headline, supporting copy sentence, primary CTA

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [FEATURED_COLLECTION]: name of the current editorial focus or seasonal edit
- [CREATOR_NAME]: optional, only if a specific creator is featured in the hero moment

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- one-stop shop
- all your beauty needs
- viral or trending
- community-loved (unless specific)
- AI-powered (unless a real feature is active)

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

Hero headline: "Discover Asian beauty with more confidence."

Supporting copy: "A curated makeup-led assortment shaped for real-life wear, explained by creators who kno

CTA: "Browse the edit"

Surface 2: PDP (product page)

SURFACE: PDP (Product Detail Page)

PURPOSE: Turn product uncertainty into purchase confidence. The shopper has found the product; the PDP confirms the choice.

AUDIENCE: A shopper who has arrived via creator content, search, or the site's own navigation. She is considering the purchase.

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

1. Why this product was selected and what makes it earn its place in the edit.
2. How it wears and performs in real life, including finish, feel, and longevity.
3. Who it suits, what routine moment it fits, and what it pairs well with.

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Selection logic ("why it made the edit")
- Product education (finish, wear, texture, use case)
- Creator credibility cue if a creator is attributed

TONE ANCHOR: Practical, informed, encouraging. Explain why it was selected, how it wears, who it suits.

LENGTH:

- "Why it made the edit" module: 20-40 words
- Wear and finish description: 30-60 words
- Creator note (if present): 20-40 words
- "Best for" label: 5-15 words

MANDATORY FIELDS: Why it made the edit, wear/finish description, best for

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [PRODUCT NAME]: full product name
- [FINISH TYPE]: e.g., soft matte, dewy, satin
- [SKIN TYPE FIT]: e.g., works especially well on oily lids, suited to medium-to-deeper skin tones
- [ROUTINE MOMENT]: e.g., everyday base, evening lip, quick morning routine
- [CREATOR NAME]: optional, only if a creator brief specifically covers this product
- [ROUTINE_PAIRING]: optional, one or two products this pairs with

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- works for everyone
- transform your skin
- clinically proven (unless the product carries substantiated evidence)
- viral or best-seller (unless verified by real sales data)
- you need this

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

Why it made the edit: "Chosen for a soft-matte finish that wears through the day without settling into lines.
Wear description: "Applies smoothly with a lip brush or directly from the bullet. Builds from sheer to full coverage.
Best for: "Definition without heaviness. Everyday office wear or evening looks."

Surface 3: Creator brief

SURFACE: Creator brief

PURPOSE: Align a creator on their role, tone, content direction, and brand standards for a Simplex-ity collaboration.

AUDIENCE: A creator partner who has agreed to collaborate with Simplex-ity. They are a beauty educator with a following.

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

1. Teach with real product knowledge: show the finish, the wear, the routine moment.
2. Demonstrate real-life fit and use: not a performance, a demonstration.
3. Maintain Simplex-ity's trust-first tone: calm, credible, educational.

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Creator credibility (the brief should acknowledge what makes this creator the right fit)
- Product education (the brief should give the creator enough product detail to teach accurately)

TONE ANCHOR: Elevated, collaborative, credible. Teach first, translate fit and use case, keep the tone calm and educational.

LENGTH:

- Brief overview: 40-60 words
- Key messages to communicate: 3-5 bullets
- Content direction: 30-50 words
- What not to do: 3-5 bullets

MANDATORY FIELDS: Product featured, key message to teach, tone direction, what not to say or show

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [PRODUCT NAME]: full product name
- [CAMPAIGN FOCUS]: the editorial angle for this collaboration
- [CREATOR NAME]: creator's name or handle
- [TARGET ROUTINE MOMENT]: the specific use case to demonstrate
- [KEY_PRODUCT_ATTRIBUTES]: 2-3 attributes to feature (finish, wear, texture)

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- Do not ask the creator to say "you need this," "life-changing," or "this is my new favourite" without getting the creator's approval.
- Do not use urgency or scarcity language in creator content.
- Do not ask for unboxing-style content that leads with price or discount.
- Do not describe Simplex-ity as a one-stop shop or a beauty-tech platform.
- Do not use the word "viral" as a content goal.

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

"[CREATOR_NAME], your job with [PRODUCT_NAME] is to make it easier to understand, easier to picture on real life."

Surface 4: Service reply

SURFACE: Service reply

PURPOSE: Resolve a customer issue while maintaining and, where possible, strengthening trust in the brand.

AUDIENCE: An existing customer with a problem, complaint, or question about an order, a product, or a return.

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

1. Acknowledge the situation directly and without deflection.
2. Give a clear, specific resolution or next step.
3. Leave her with more trust than before, not less.

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Quality of experience (maintained even in failure states)
- Honest and direct acknowledgement (not scripted warmth)

TONE ANCHOR: Calm, direct, human, trust-repairing. No deflection. No scripted warmth that does not land.

LENGTH: 40-80 words. Shorter for simple resolutions; longer only when the situation genuinely requires more detail.

MANDATORY FIELDS: Acknowledgement of the specific situation, resolution or next step, contact route for follow-up.

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [CUSTOMER NAME]: customer's first name
- [ORDER NUMBER]: order reference
- [ISSUE TYPE]: e.g., delayed shipment, wrong item, return request, product question
- [RESOLUTION ACTION]: what is being done
- [CARRIER]: shipping carrier name, if relevant
- [DATE]: specific date, if relevant to resolution

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- "We apologise for any inconvenience" (hollow; say what you are actually sorry for)
- "Per our policy" (deflective; own the situation)
- "Please note" (corporate hedging)
- "Rest assured" (empty reassurance without a concrete action)
- Any brand lifestyle language in a complaint context

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

"Hi [CUSTOMER_NAME], we've looked into this. Your order left our warehouse on [DATE] with [CARRIER]. Here's what we can do for you."

Surface 5: Social (IG + TikTok captions)

SURFACE: Social captions (Instagram and TikTok)

PURPOSE:

Instagram: add a purposeful, trust-building layer beneath a strong visual. The image carries the mood; the copy works alongside it.

TikTok: hook the viewer in the first line and give them a reason to stay or act. The copy works alongside the video.

AUDIENCE:

Instagram: existing followers and discovery-stage consumers who encounter Simplex-ity via the feed or explore page.

TikTok: discovery-stage consumers arriving via the algorithm, often encountering Simplex-ity for the first time.

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

Instagram: (1) Why this product or moment matters. (2) A useful fact, perspective, or trust signal.
TikTok: (1) A hook that earns the next 30 seconds. (2) One useful takeaway.

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Selection logic visible for product posts (why this, not just what this)
- Creator credibility visible for creator posts (who is this person and why do they know)

TONE ANCHOR:

Instagram: editorial, purposeful, confident. The caption adds the useful or trust layer beneath the visual.
TikTok: hook-first, slightly more casual, still on-brand and never trend-chasing.

LENGTH:

Instagram: 30-100 words, not including hashtags.
TikTok: 10-40 words, front-loaded with the hook.

MANDATORY FIELDS:

Product posts: what the product does or why it was selected.
Creator posts: creator name and the product featured.

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [PRODUCT_NAME]: product name
- [KEY_ATTRIBUTE]: the one attribute worth leading with (finish, formula, wear)
- [CREATOR_NAME]: optional, only if a creator is featured
- [COLLECTION_NAME]: optional, if this is part of an edit or campaign

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- glow up
- obsessed (as brand voice)
- sells out fast, going fast, limited time
- viral or TikTok famous (as aspirational positioning)
- slays, iconic, hits different

EXAMPLE OUTPUT (Instagram): "Why this made the edit: buildable coverage that doesn't settle into pores. Share with your friend who needs this." [Shop now](#)
EXAMPLE OUTPUT (TikTok): "Most people skip this step. Here's why it matters for glass skin." [Watch this](#)

Surface 6: Email (subject line + body)

SURFACE: Email (subject line and body)

PURPOSE: Earn the open with a subject line that feels like something worth reading, not a promotion. Then

AUDIENCE: Existing subscribers or customers who have opted in. They have some familiarity with Simplex-ity

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

1. One clear editorial focus: not multiple competing products or messages.
2. Useful information or perspective the reader did not already have.
3. A single clear action.

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Selection logic (why this product or collection was chosen)
- Product education (what it is, how it wears, why it belongs)

TONE ANCHOR: Trusted editor tone. Subject: intriguing, no false urgency, no all-caps. Body: one clear focus

LENGTH:

- Subject line: 5-9 words
- Preheader: 10-20 words
- Body: 60-150 words
- CTA: 3-6 words

MANDATORY FIELDS: Subject line, preheader, body copy, single CTA

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [PRODUCT_NAME]: product name
- [COLLECTION_NAME]: collection or edit name, if relevant
- [EDITORIAL_ANGLE]: the one angle that makes this email worth opening (formula story, creator note, routine)
- [CTA_DESTINATION]: where the CTA links

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- "Don't miss this" or "Act now"
- "Last chance" or "Final hours"
- "You won't believe"
- Any scarcity or urgency language unless genuinely true and operationally backed

- Multiple competing CTAs

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

Subject: "The one shade you need this summer."

Preheader: "A formula we haven't seen before. Here's why it made the edit."

Body: "We haven't seen anything like this formula. It's the first fluffy dewy blush that applies on wet bu

CTA: "See the shade"

Surface 7: Error and empty states

SURFACE: Error and empty states

PURPOSE: Keep the user oriented and confident when something is missing, broken, or not found. A well-writ

AUDIENCE: Any Simplex-ity site visitor who has hit a dead end: a failed search, an empty cart, a 404, an c

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

1. Honest, calm acknowledgement of what happened.
2. A clear, specific next step.
3. The experience of the brand feeling helpful, not broken.

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Quality of experience (maintained even when things go wrong)

TONE ANCHOR: Calm, honest, helpful. No false cheer. No brand jargon when something breaks. Direct, with a

LENGTH: 5-20 words per state. Shorter is better. One action maximum per state.

MANDATORY FIELDS: What happened (briefly), what to do next.

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [STATE TYPE]: 404, empty search, empty cart, out of stock, payment error
- [NEXT_ACTION]: the specific next step to offer

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- "Oops!" (false cheer; not brand-appropriate for any failure state)
- "Something went wrong on our end" with no resolution (owns nothing, offers nothing)
- Brand lifestyle language in any error state
- Language that makes the error feel larger or more alarming than it is
- Apologetic language that does not come with a resolution

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

Empty search: "Nothing matched that search. Try a texture, finish, or brand name instead."

Empty cart: "Your cart's empty. Start with a look or browse the current edit."

404: "This page isn't here. Head back to the shop or search for what you're looking for."

Out of stock: "This one's out right now. Sign up to hear when it's back, or explore similar picks."

Surface 8: Investor-facing

SURFACE: Investor-facing copy

PURPOSE: Communicate the Simplex-ity business thesis and phase 1 discipline clearly, credibly, and concise

AUDIENCE: Potential or existing investors in Simplex-ity. They expect commercially specific, data-anchored

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

1. The business case for the trust-first, curated model in the Asian beauty category.
2. Phase 1 discipline: what the first phase proves and why those proof points matter.
3. Platform potential: what becomes possible once the phase 1 model is validated.

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Claim discipline (investor copy signals how the team will behave with consumers too; if copy over-claims

TONE ANCHOR: Data-anchored, commercially specific, confident. No lifestyle hyperbole. Brand discipline sig

LENGTH:

- One-liner: 15-25 words
- Paragraph: 60-100 words
- No filler or padding

MANDATORY FIELDS: Market context or problem, differentiated model, phase 1 focus, what phase 1 proves

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [PHASE]: current phase designation
- [KEY METRICS]: specific metrics when available (GMV targets, conversion rates, repeat purchase rates)
- [MARKET_SIZE]: addressable market figure when available and sourced

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- disrupt, revolutionize, game-changer
- one-of-a-kind, unique (without specifics)
- any lifestyle or beauty-editorial language that loses credibility in an investment context
- over-claiming operational capabilities not yet in place (direct authorization, guaranteed fulfilment SLA)

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

"Phase 1 validates trust and conversion mechanics through a makeup-led, curated assortment with creator-gu

Surface 9: Partner-facing (creator and brand outreach)

SURFACE: Partner-facing copy (creator and brand partner outreach)

PURPOSE: Earn a positive response from a potential creator or brand partner by communicating who Simplex-ity

AUDIENCE: A creator or brand being approached for partnership. They receive many outreach messages. The or

PRIMARY MESSAGE PRIORITY:

1. Who Simplex-ity is and what it stands for (concise; one sentence).
2. Why this specific partner is a fit (specific; not generic praise).
3. What the relationship looks like and what happens next (practical; one clear step).

REQUIRED TRUST SIGNALS:

- Credibility and selectivity (the brand is worth partnering with because it is discerning)
- Honest expectations (the brief is clear about what the partner is being asked to do)

TONE ANCHOR: Collaborative, peer tone. Clear about what Simplex-ity asks and why. Sets honest expectations

LENGTH:

- Opening: 30-50 words
- Full outreach message: 100-150 words maximum
- Less is more

MANDATORY FIELDS: Brand description (one sentence), specific reason this partner is a fit, what partnership

FILLABLE VARIABLES:

- [PARTNER_NAME]: creator's name or brand name
- [PARTNER_TYPE]: creator or brand
- [SPECIFIC FIT REASON]: the concrete reason this partner is being approached (their content style, audience, etc.)
- [PROPOSED_NEXT_STEP]: what you are asking them to do (reply, schedule a call, review a brief)

DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS:

- "We'd love to collaborate!" (generic; says nothing)
- "Huge opportunity" or "massive reach" (signals desperation)
- "We're big fans of your content" without specifics (hollow flattery)
- Any language that makes the relationship sound purely transactional
- Follower count as the basis for the pitch

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

"Hi [PARTNER_NAME], we're building a more trusted, more guided way to shop Asian beauty for Western-market

12.3 Image-generation style anchors

Three templates for generating on-brand imagery using Midjourney, DALL-E, or equivalent tools. Load the master system-prompt block before using these templates. Use the template that matches the image type needed.

Template 1: Product still-life

POSITIVE PROMPT:

editorial flat-lay of Asian beauty products, soft lavender linen surface, dried botanicals and silk fabric

NEGATIVE PROMPT:

no floating UI elements, no AI badges or tech overlays, no neon lighting, no overcrowded compositions with

REFERENCE ANCHORS:

The target aesthetic is a styled product flat-lay with the following qualities: a soft, pale lavender or s

PALETTE LOCKS:

Primary surface tone: #e8e6fe (lavender wash) or #ffffff (white)
Accent: #8c82fc (primary lilac) for small elements if any brand colour is visible
Background: #ffffff dominant
Avoid: any colour outside the approved palette, especially warm oranges, reds, or saturated greens

Template 2: Creator portrait

POSITIVE PROMPT:

real East Asian or Southeast Asian woman, beauty educator aesthetic, editorial clothing in neutral or soft

NEGATIVE PROMPT:

no AI-generated or artificially smoothed faces, no ring-light flat lighting or hot spots, no chaotic or di

REFERENCE ANCHORS:

The target aesthetic is a creator portrait with the following qualities: a real person with natural skin a

PALETTE LOCKS:

Backdrop: #ffffff or #e8e6fe (lavender wash)
Clothing: neutral tones, not competing with the palette
Accent: subtle #bab4fd if a surface colour is visible
Avoid: bright primary colours, heavy warm tones, any off-palette accent

Template 3: Hero composition

POSITIVE PROMPT:

full-width editorial beauty brand hero image, white canvas dominant with at least 60 percent white space,

NEGATIVE PROMPT:

no tech-UI overlays or floating interface elements, no AI-powered badges or digital effect overlays, no AI

REFERENCE ANCHORS:

The target aesthetic is the opening spread of an upmarket beauty retail brand: white space dominant, one e

PALETTE LOCKS:

Background dominant: #ffffff
Brand signal: #8c82fc (primary lilac) in small, intentional area only
Support: #e8e6fe (lavender wash) for very subtle secondary areas
Body text colour if overlaid: #1a1a1f
Avoid: any colour outside the approved palette

12.4 Do-not-say register

The full prohibitions list. Machine-parsable YAML for AI tools; the table version in Section 7 is the human-readable reference. Categories: `hype` , `discount` , `false_tech` , `false_community` , `overclaim` , `medical_clinical` , `scarcity_urgency` , `generic_beauty` .

```
do_not_say:
# HYPE: generic excitement, meaningless superlatives, trend-chasing energy
- phrase: "one-stop shop"
```

category: hype
reason: "generic, chases breadth, directly contradicts the curation positioning"
alternative: "curated selection | edited assortment"

- phrase: "hottest picks"
category: hype
reason: "trend-chasing language, signals mass-market not editorial"
alternative: "current edit | selected products"

- phrase: "must-have"
category: hype
reason: "empty urgency, implies everyone should want this without a reason"
alternative: "worth trying | made the edit because..."

- phrase: "game-changer"
category: hype
reason: "overused, inflated, no specific meaning"
alternative: "(drop; explain what specifically changed and why)"

- phrase: "disrupt"
category: hype
reason: "empty tech language, no emotional or commercial value"
alternative: "(drop; rewrite sentence without it)"

- phrase: "disruptive"
category: hype
reason: "same as disrupt; also signals startup-speak that conflicts with the beauty editorial tone"
alternative: "(drop; rewrite sentence without it)"

- phrase: "revolutionize"
category: hype
reason: "overclaims at a category level; not backed by evidence"
alternative: "(drop; be specific about what changed)"

- phrase: "cutting-edge"
category: hype
reason: "tech-adjacent hype with no specific content"
alternative: "(drop; describe the specific advancement)"

- phrase: "next-level"
category: hype
reason: "meaningless comparator; sounds like gaming or fitness, not beauty editorial"
alternative: "(drop; be specific about what improved)"

- phrase: "elevate your routine"
category: hype
reason: "overused in beauty; vague without a specific mechanism"
alternative: "simplify your routine | add one step that changes the result"

- phrase: "viral"
category: hype
reason: "trend-chasing signal that directly conflicts with the curation positioning"
alternative: "(drop; explain why something is worth trying)"

- phrase: "TikTok famous"
category: hype
reason: "anchors the brand to platform trends rather than product quality"
alternative: "(drop; describe the product's actual merit)"

- phrase: "trending now"
category: hype
reason: "signals algorithmic discovery rather than editorial curation"
alternative: "in the current edit | selected this season"

- phrase: "ultimate"
category: hype
reason: "superlative with no referent; undermines specificity"
alternative: "(drop; be specific about what makes this product the right choice)"

- phrase: "iconic"
category: hype
reason: "overused to the point of meaninglessness in beauty content"
alternative: "(drop; describe what makes the product distinctive)"

DISCOUNT: price-first, deal-driven, low-trust language

- phrase: "best prices everywhere"
category: discount
reason: "positions the brand on price, not curation or trust; attracts the wrong segment"
alternative: "(drop; Simplex-ity does not compete on price)"

- phrase: "unbeatable deals"
category: discount
reason: "discount marketplace energy; directly contradicts the editorial positioning"
alternative: "(drop)"
 - phrase: "flash sale"
category: discount
reason: "promotional language that conflicts with the calm, curated brand feel"
alternative: "(avoid sales-led language altogether; if a promotion is genuine, describe it plainly)"
 - phrase: "biggest beauty sale"
category: discount
reason: "mass-market promotional language"
alternative: "(drop)"
 - # FALSE TECH: technology claims that are not backed by real features
 - phrase: "AI-powered personalisation"
category: false tech
reason: "makes a specific technical claim that must be backed by a real, active feature"
alternative: "guided discovery | curated recommendations"
 - phrase: "intelligent beauty"
category: false tech
reason: "vague tech language that implies AI capability without specifics"
alternative: "(drop; describe the actual guidance mechanism)"
 - phrase: "smart beauty technology"
category: false tech
reason: "tech-forward positioning that conflicts with the trust-first, beauty-editorial direction"
alternative: "(drop; let technology appear as support, not the lead)"
 - phrase: "beauty-tech platform"
category: false tech
reason: "positions the brand as a technology product rather than a trusted beauty retailer"
alternative: "beauty discovery platform | curated beauty retail"
 - phrase: "algorithm-driven discovery"
category: false tech
reason: "implies impersonal, automated curation; conflicts with the edited, human-led positioning"
alternative: "creator-guided discovery | editorially curated"
 - phrase: "AI-powered"
category: false tech
reason: "only usable when a specific, active AI feature backs it"
alternative: "(describe the real feature, or drop)"
 - # FALSE COMMUNITY: community or social proof claims without verifiable backing
 - phrase: "community-loved"
category: false community
reason: "vague social proof without a verifiable basis; can mislead"
alternative: "chosen by [specific creator or group] | part of [named creator's] routine"
 - phrase: "creator-approved"
category: false community
reason: "vague attribution; requires a specific, named, verifiable creator"
alternative: "recommended by [CREATOR_NAME] | featured in [CREATOR_NAME]'s routine"
 - phrase: "influencer-approved"
category: false community
reason: "influencer framing conflicts with the educator-not-influencer creator positioning"
alternative: "recommended by [CREATOR_NAME]"
 - phrase: "our girls"
category: false community
reason: "forced community language that reads as manufactured rather than earned"
alternative: "(drop; let community form around real content and value)"
 - phrase: "squad goals"
category: false community
reason: "internet slang that conflicts with the editorial positioning"
alternative: "(drop)"
 - phrase: "community-voted"
category: false community
reason: "implies a voting mechanism that may not exist"
alternative: "(drop unless a real voting or rating mechanism is in place)"
 - phrase: "everyone's talking about"
category: false community
reason: "vague social proof with no verifiable basis"
-

alternative: "(drop; cite the specific source or drop entirely)"

OVERCLAIM: claims that overstate what the brand or product can do

- phrase: "works for everyone"
category: overclaim
reason: "no beauty product works for everyone; this claim undermines the relevance-first positioning"
alternative: "works especially well for [specific skin type or use case]"

- phrase: "all your beauty needs"
category: overclaim
reason: "breadth claim that conflicts with the curation and selectivity positioning"
alternative: "a curated edit of [category] essentials"

- phrase: "complete beauty solution"
category: overclaim
reason: "overclaims scope; sounds like a mass-market proposition"
alternative: "(drop; be specific about what is offered and why)"

- phrase: "everything you need"
category: overclaim
reason: "breadth claim; same problem as 'all your beauty needs'"
alternative: "(drop; describe what is specifically offered)"

- phrase: "the best of Asian beauty"
category: overclaim
reason: "superlative claim that cannot be substantiated"
alternative: "a curated edit of Asian beauty | selected Asian beauty essentials"

MEDICAL CLINICAL: efficacy or health-adjacent claims without substantiation

- phrase: "clinically proven"
category: medical clinical
reason: "requires substantiated clinical evidence; cannot be used without it"
alternative: "(drop unless the product carries peer-reviewed clinical evidence)"

- phrase: "dermatologist recommended"
category: medical clinical
reason: "requires a verifiable dermatologist recommendation; cannot be used without it"
alternative: "(drop unless a real dermatologist endorsement is on record)"

- phrase: "dermatologist approved"
category: medical clinical
reason: "same as dermatologist recommended"
alternative: "(drop unless verified)"

- phrase: "scientifically formulated"
category: medical clinical
reason: "vague clinical language; requires specific scientific backing"
alternative: "(drop unless specific formulation evidence is available)"

- phrase: "proven results"
category: medical clinical
reason: "claims proof that may not exist; vague and potentially misleading"
alternative: "(drop unless specific, sourced evidence backs it)"

- phrase: "transform your skin"
category: medical clinical
reason: "overclaims a clinical outcome; raises consumer expectation beyond what product can deliver"
alternative: "improve your routine | see the difference in how your skin feels"

SCARCITY URGENCY: false urgency or manufactured scarcity

- phrase: "don't miss out"
category: scarcity urgency
reason: "FOMO language; conflicts with the calm, trust-building brand tone"
alternative: "(drop; let the product speak for itself)"

- phrase: "limited time offer"
category: scarcity urgency
reason: "promotional urgency that conflicts with the editorial brand feel; only use when genuinely true"
alternative: "(use only when the time limit is real; then state the actual deadline plainly)"

- phrase: "selling out fast"
category: scarcity urgency
reason: "manufactured urgency; only use when real stock data supports it"
alternative: "(use only when real low-stock data is confirmed)"

- phrase: "only X left"
category: scarcity urgency
reason: "scarcity language; only use when the number is real and accurate"
alternative: "(use only when real-time stock data confirms it)"

- phrase: "act now"
category: scarcity urgency
reason: "aggressive urgency language; not consistent with the brand's calm, trust-first voice"
alternative: "(drop; use a plain CTA instead)"
- phrase: "hurry"
category: scarcity urgency
reason: "same as act now"
alternative: "(drop)"
- # GENERIC BEAUTY: beauty category clichés that dilute the editorial position
- phrase: "all-natural"
category: generic beauty
reason: "unregulated claim; legally ambiguous and overused in beauty"
alternative: "(drop unless the product has a specific certified-natural credential)"
- phrase: "clean beauty"
category: generic beauty
reason: "undefined term; means different things to different consumers and regulators"
alternative: "(drop unless the brand has defined what clean means for Simplex-ity and can back it)"
- phrase: "glow up"
category: generic beauty
reason: "internet slang; conflicts with the editorial tone"
alternative: "(drop)"
- phrase: "your best skin ever"
category: generic beauty
reason: "overclaims a personal outcome; sounds like mass-market advertising"
alternative: "skin that feels more like itself | a routine that works with your skin"
- phrase: "goddess-worthy"
category: generic beauty
reason: "aspirational language that reads as empty flattery"
alternative: "(drop)"
- phrase: "beauty that works for you"
category: generic beauty
reason: "vague and generic; every beauty brand says this"
alternative: "(drop; be specific about what works and why)"

12.5 Brand self-check rubric

Run this rubric on every piece of copy before it is returned or published. Score each item 0, 1, or 2.

- **0 (fail):** this item is violated. The copy must be revised before use.
- **1 (partial):** this item is present but weak, unclear, or only partially satisfied. Revise if time allows; flag if not.
- **2 (pass):** this item is clearly and fully satisfied.

Minimum acceptable score per item: 1. If any item scores 0, revise before returning or publishing.

Prose rubric

Cluster 1: Message hierarchy (items 1-4)

1. Trust leads. The first claim or impression in this copy is trust-building, not aspirational, desirability-first, or technology-forward.
2. Guidance follows. If guidance content is present, it comes after trust has been established, not before.
3. Desirability is present but supporting. Desirability claims (beauty, aspiration, excitement) appear in the copy but are not the dominant or first message.
4. Technology is supporting, not hero. If technology is mentioned, it appears as a tool or benefit in service of the experience. It is not the brand's lead claim or the frame the copy is built around.

Cluster 2: Trust signals (items 5-9)

5. Authenticity cue present when needed. If the copy makes a sourcing or authenticity claim (e.g., “directly from brands”, “authorized”), a basis for that claim is visible in the copy or the surrounding context.
6. Creator credibility cue visible when needed. If a creator is attributed or referenced, something in the copy implies or states why they are a relevant voice (their expertise, their content type, or their use of the product).
7. Product education is visible. The copy gives the reader enough information to understand what the product does, how it wears, or who it is for. It does not just name the product and expect the reader to decide.
8. Recommendation basis is clear. If a recommendation is made, the basis is understandable. “Recommended by [creator]” is clear. “Handpicked for you” without any further context is not.
9. No medical or clinical overreach. No efficacy, dermatological, or clinical claim appears without substantiated evidence. “Works especially well on oily lids” is acceptable. “Clinically proven to reduce pores” is not unless the evidence exists.

Cluster 3: Language register (items 10-14)

10. At least one “lean into” word or phrase from the approved register (Section 7) is present in the copy.
11. No word or phrase from the “avoid” column (Section 7) appears in the copy.
12. No “use with care” word (Section 7) appears without a specific, verifiable claim backing its use in this context.
13. No slang, trend language, or internet shorthand that contradicts the editorial positioning. This includes: glow up, slay, obsessed (as brand voice), iconic (as generic praise), hits different.
14. No em dashes appear in the copy. This is a hard rule with no exceptions for AI-generated output.

Cluster 4: Tone fit for surface (items 15-18)

15. The tone direction matches the surface being written for. Use the tone matrix in Section 6 to check. A homepage headline should not read like a service reply. A TikTok caption should not read like an investor statement.
16. The copy length is within the specified word range for this surface. Use the per-surface templates in Section 12.2 to check.
17. All mandatory fields for this surface are present. Check the MANDATORY FIELDS line in the relevant surface template.
18. The surface-specific do-not-say list for this surface has been respected. Check the DO-NOT-SAY REMINDERS line in the relevant surface template.

Cluster 5: Proof discipline (items 19-22)

19. No authorization or sourcing claim goes beyond “curated with intent” without operational backing confirmed by the team.
20. No speed or fulfilment claim (fastest shipping, guaranteed delivery by a specific date, no split shipment) appears without confirmed operational proof.
21. No “community-loved” or “creator-approved” language appears without a specific, named, and verifiable basis. “Loved by the community” is not acceptable. “Part of [CREATOR_NAME]'s weekly routine” is.
22. No AI-powered personalisation claim appears without a real, currently active feature behind it. If the feature does not exist yet, the claim does not appear.

Cluster 6: Visual-verbal consistency (items 23-25)

23. If this copy is paired with an image, the image follows the imagery direction in Section 11: editorial still-life or real creator portrait, brand palette, no AI-generated faces, no tech-UI overlays.
24. If this copy references a creator or attributes a recommendation, the creator's visual presence in any accompanying image reads as editorial rather than influencer-chaotic.
25. If this copy claims curation, the copy itself reads selective. It is not verbose, crowded, or padded with multiple competing claims. A curated brand should produce curated copy.
-

Machine-parsable rubric (YAML)

```
brand self check_rubric:
  version: "1.0"
  scoring: "0 = fail (revise before use), 1 = partial (revise if possible), 2 = pass"
  minimum_acceptable_score_per_item: 1

clusters:

  - name: "Message hierarchy"
    items:
      - id: 1
        check: "Trust leads: first claim or impression is trust-building, not aspirational or tech-forward"
        score: null

      - id: 2
        check: "Guidance follows: if guidance appears, it comes after trust is established"
        score: null

      - id: 3
        check: "Desirability is supporting: desirability claims present but not dominant"
        score: null

      - id: 4
        check: "Technology is supporting: if mentioned, appears as enhancement not lead claim"
        score: null

  - name: "Trust signals"
    items:
      - id: 5
        check: "Authenticity cue present if sourcing claim made: basis is visible"
        score: null

      - id: 6
        check: "Creator credibility cue visible if creator attributed: relevance implied or stated"
        score: null

      - id: 7
        check: "Product education visible: copy explains what product does, wears, or suits"
        score: null

      - id: 8
        check: "Recommendation basis clear: basis is understandable, not mysterious"
        score: null

      - id: 9
        check: "No medical or clinical overreach: no unsubstantiated efficacy claims"
        score: null

  - name: "Language register"
    items:
      - id: 10
        check: "At least one lean-into word or phrase from approved register (Section 7) present"
        score: null

      - id: 11
        check: "No avoid word or phrase from prohibited register (Section 7) present"
        score: null

      - id: 12
        check: "No use-with-care word without specific verifiable claim backing it"
        score: null

      - id: 13
        check: "No slang, trend language, or internet shorthand present"
        score: null
```

- id: 14
check: "No em dashes present"
score: null
- name: "Tone fit for surface"
items:
 - id: 15
check: "Tone direction matches the surface per Section 6 tone matrix"
score: null
 - id: 16
check: "Copy length within specified word range for this surface (Section 12.2)"
score: null
 - id: 17
check: "All mandatory fields for this surface are present (Section 12.2)"
score: null
 - id: 18
check: "Surface-specific do-not-say list respected (Section 12.2)"
score: null
- name: "Proof discipline"
items:
 - id: 19
check: "No authorization or sourcing claim beyond curated-with-intent without operational backing"
score: null
 - id: 20
check: "No speed or fulfilment claim without confirmed operational proof"
score: null
 - id: 21
check: "No community-loved or creator-approved language without specific named verifiable basis"
score: null
 - id: 22
check: "No AI-powered personalisation claim without a real currently active feature"
score: null
- name: "Visual-verbal consistency"
items:
 - id: 23
check: "If paired with image: image follows Section 11 imagery direction"
score: null
 - id: 24
check: "If creator referenced: creator visual is editorial not influencer-chaotic"
score: null
 - id: 25
check: "If curation claimed: copy itself reads selective, not verbose or padded"
score: null

12.6 Human-review escalation rules

The following categories of copy must be reviewed by a human team member before publishing, regardless of rubric score. An AI tool passing the self-check rubric does not override this list.

Category	Why human review is required
Any sourcing, authorization, or authenticity claim beyond “curated with intent”	These claims have legal and reputational consequences. Operations must confirm the claim is accurate before it appears.
Any medical, clinical, dermatological, or efficacy-adjacent language	These claims are regulated in most markets. Even accurate claims may require legal review before use.
Founder or executive quotes	Quotes must be approved by the individual being quoted. AI should not generate or paraphrase quotes attributed to real people.
Pricing, discount, or promotional offer copy	Price accuracy and promotion terms require human confirmation. Errors create legal and trust risk.
Partnership, brand exclusivity, or launch announcements	These involve third-party relationships and contractual obligations that must be confirmed before publication.
Investor-facing copy	Investor communications carry regulatory implications. All investor-facing copy requires review by Jenny or Kieran before use.
Crisis response, incident, or customer-complaint reply templates	Crisis and complaint handling requires human judgment. AI-drafted responses must be reviewed before sending.
Any copy translated or adapted for a non-English market	Translated copy must be reviewed by a native speaker of the target language before publication.

12.7 Claude Design setup guide

This section is the bridge between this brand book and Claude Design. Any team member should be able to open this section, follow the steps, and complete Claude Design’s “Set up your design system” flow without needing to hunt through the rest of the document.

Step 1: Gather the asset files

Before opening Claude Design, assemble the following. Sources are noted.

Asset	Where to get it	Status
<code>simplex-ity_logo_fullcolour.png</code>	Extracted from <code>Simplexity_Brand_Guidelines.pdf</code> pages 3-4 (Phase 7 build task)	Pending Phase 7
<code>simplex-ity_logo_white.png</code>	Same source	Pending Phase 7
<code>simplex-ity_logo_black.png</code>	Same source	Pending Phase 7
Exo font files	Download from Google Fonts: fonts.google.com/specimen/Exo	Ready to download
Montserrat font files	Download from Google Fonts: fonts.google.com/specimen/Montserrat	Ready to download
<code>simplex-ity_colour_palette.png</code>	Generated in Phase 7 from the 6 hex values in Section 11.1	Pending Phase 7

Step 2: Complete the Claude Design fields

Open Claude Design and go to “Set up your design system.” Fill each field as follows:

Company name and blurb:

Simplex-ity: a trust-first, makeup-forward Asian beauty retail brand for Western-market shoppers. Curated

Link code on GitHub: Leave blank unless the front-end repository is available.

Link code from your computer: Upload the front-end components folder once the Shopify build is live. Skip at this stage.

Upload a .fig file: Upload the Figma design system file once it is built. Skip at this stage.

Add fonts, logos and assets: Upload all files from Step 1 above.

Any other notes: Copy and paste the brand brief block below in full.

Step 3: Paste the brand brief block

Copy this block in full into the “Any other notes” field in Claude Design. Do not abbreviate.

```
BRAND: Simplex-ity
CATEGORY: Asian beauty retail, North America
POSITIONING: A more trusted, more guided way for Western-market consumers to discover and buy Asian beauty
BRAND IDEA: Asian beauty, made easier to trust, learn, and love.

PERSONALITY: Elevated, calming, credible, contemporary, curated, clear. More guide than guru. More curator
VOICE IN ONE SENTENCE: Clear, polished, trust-building. Warm without being sugary, modern without being re

COLOUR PALETTE:
  Primary lilac: #8c82fc
  Accent violet: #5e50fb
  Soft lilac: #bab4fd
  Lavender wash: #e8e6fe
  White canvas: #ffffff
  Neutral grey: #e6e6e6
  Body text: #1a1a1f

TYPOGRAPHY:
  Headlines and slogans: Exo (Google Fonts)
  Body and secondary headers: Montserrat (Google Fonts)
  Fallback: Calibri

MESSAGE HIERARCHY: Trust first, then Guidance, then Desirability, then Technology as support (never hero).

PUNCTUATION RULE: No em dashes in any generated copy. Use a colon, comma, semicolon, or rewrite the sentence.

DO NOT USE: one-stop shop, hottest picks, viral, beauty hacks, disrupt, game-changer, AI-powered (unless a

IMAGERY DIRECTION: Editorial product still-life (soft lavender surfaces, botanicals, luminous lighting, 2-

SELF-CHECK: Before returning any copy output, run it against the 25-item Brand Self-Check Rubric. If any i
```


Section 13: Worked examples library

This section contains 36 examples across all 9 brand surfaces. Each surface has four variants: three on-brand (A, B, C) and one off-brand (D) with a line-by-line diagnosis against the 25-item Brand Self-Check Rubric from Section 12.5.

How to use this section: - Use on-brand variants A, B, and C as reference for the range of voice the brand can produce within a single surface. They are not identical; the variation is intentional. A brand with only one way to say something is brittle. - Use variant D and its diagnosis to understand where AI tools and human writers most commonly go wrong for that surface. The diagnosis cites rubric items by number and cluster name. - When using this section to train or evaluate AI output, load the master system-prompt block from Section 12.1 first.

Rubric item reference: Cluster 1 (Message hierarchy) = items 1-4. Cluster 2 (Trust signals) = items 5-9. Cluster 3 (Language register) = items 10-14. Cluster 4 (Tone fit) = items 15-18. Cluster 5 (Proof discipline) = items 19-22. Cluster 6 (Visual-verbal consistency) = items 23-25.

13.1 Homepage hero copy

Brief: Homepage headline and supporting subhead for the Simplex-ity site. A new visitor lands on this page having discovered Simplex-ity through a creator or social post. The copy must immediately communicate what Simplex-ity is and why it is worth trusting, in enough words to be clear and few enough to hold.

Variant A (on-brand)

Headline: Asian beauty, made easier to trust.

Subhead: The products that belong in your routine, selected with intent and explained by people who actually use them.

Variant B (on-brand)

Headline: Discover Asian beauty with a guide, not a guess.

Subhead: A curated edit of makeup and skincare from brands that earn their place. Creator-taught. Editorially selected.

Variant C (on-brand)

Headline: Everything here earned its place.

Subhead: Simplex-ity brings together the Asian beauty products worth trying, the creators who explain them, and the transparency to buy with confidence.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

Headline: Your one-stop shop for the HOTTEST Asian beauty picks!

Subhead: Trending products, TikTok-famous finds, and AI-powered personalisation. Shop the viral looks and get your glow up today!

Rubric failures:

- Item 1 (Cluster 1: Trust leads) – Score: 0. “Hottest picks” and “Trending products” open with trend-chasing energy. No trust signal appears before the CTA.
 - Item 4 (Cluster 1: Technology supporting) – Score: 0. “AI-powered personalisation” is presented as the lead benefit, not a supporting feature. Technology is framing the brand before trust or curation appear.
 - Item 7 (Cluster 2: Product education visible) – Score: 0. No information about what Simplex-ity carries, why products are selected, or who the site is for. The copy only signals excitement.
 - Item 11 (Cluster 3: No avoid phrase) – Score: 0. “One-stop shop”, “hottest picks”, “TikTok-famous”, “viral”, and “glow up” all appear in the prohibited register.
 - Item 15 (Cluster 4: Tone direction matches surface) – Score: 0. Homepage hero should be calm, editorial, and trust-forward. The exclamation marks and all-caps register belong to a discount-marketplace category.
 - Item 22 (Cluster 5: No AI claim without active feature) – Score: 0. “AI-powered personalisation” claims a specific active feature. If the feature does not exist in phase 1, this is a false claim.
-

13.2 Product detail page (PDP)

Brief: Product description for the TIRTIR Mask Fit Red Cushion, a Korean cushion foundation with 45 shades. The product is notable for extending its range to deeper skin tones where most cushion foundations stop. The audience is a shopper who has heard about this product, possibly through a creator, and is deciding whether to buy.

Variant A (on-brand)

The TIRTIR Mask Fit Cushion is a medium-to-full coverage cushion foundation that earns its place in this edit because of where most cushion ranges give up: the deeper shades. TIRTIR built 45 shades. The darker end of the range was developed with the same formula attention as the core. The finish is semi-matte, skin-like rather than powdery, and it holds through heat without oxidising noticeably. If you have been dismissed by other cushion ranges, this one was built with you in mind.

Variant B (on-brand)

Most cushion foundations are calibrated for pale East Asian skin. TIRTIR noticed the gap. The Mask Fit extends to 45 shades, with medium-deep options that were engineered rather than added as an afterthought. Medium-to-full coverage. Semi-matte finish. Resists humidity and warmth without slipping or shifting. It photographs naturally across a wider range of skin depths than most cushions in this category.

Variant C (on-brand)

What makes this cushion different is the shade architecture. 45 shades, with the deeper range treated with the same formula care as the lighter ones. Mia Chen, who has been reviewing Korean cushions for three years, uses this one when she needs coverage that does not look like coverage. Semi-matte finish, skin-like result, stable in heat. The

coverage is buildable without ever reading heavy.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

OMG you NEED this cushion in your life!! The TIRTIR Mask Fit is the most iconic, game-changing cushion in all of K-beauty right now. It is clinically proven to give you flawless, porcelain skin and the whole community is absolutely OBSESSED. TikTok-famous and community-loved, this one is selling out fast. Only a few left so grab yours before it is gone!

Rubric failures:

- Item 1 (Cluster 1: Trust leads) – Score: 0. “OMG you NEED this” opens with hype urgency. No trust signal precedes the excitement.
 - Item 7 (Cluster 2: Product education visible) – Score: 0. No meaningful product information is given. All claims are superlative, not descriptive. A reader learns nothing about how the cushion performs.
 - Item 9 (Cluster 2: No medical or clinical overreach) – Score: 0. “Clinically proven to give you flawless, porcelain skin” is an unsubstantiated clinical claim. The phrasing also implies a skin-perfecting outcome that conflicts with the brand’s natural-skin imagery direction.
 - Item 11 (Cluster 3: No avoid phrase) – Score: 0. “Game-changing”, “iconic”, “TikTok-famous”, “community-loved”, and “selling out fast” all appear in the prohibited register.
 - Item 13 (Cluster 3: No slang or trend language) – Score: 0. “OMG”, “OBSESSED” as brand voice, and “you NEED this” are brand-register violations.
 - Item 21 (Cluster 5: No unverified community claim) – Score: 0. “Community-loved” appears without a named or verifiable basis.
 - Item 25 (Cluster 6: Copy reads selective) – Score: 0. The copy stacks six competing hype claims in five sentences. It reads as catalogue noise, not curated edit.
-

13.3 Creator brief

Brief: A brief to creator Jasmine K, a beauty educator with a focus on Korean skincare, for a 60-second educational video on the COSRX Advanced Snail 96 Mucin Power Essence. The goal is for a viewer to finish the video understanding what snail mucin does and whether this product belongs in their routine.

Variant A (on-brand)

Jasmine, we would like you to cover the COSRX Advanced Snail 96 Mucin Power Essence for a 60-second piece. The brief: explain what snail mucin actually does to the skin and why the 96% concentration in this formula matters. Show how it applies, the texture, how it absorbs, and how it layers under moisturiser. The goal is to help someone who has heard about snail mucin but does not know whether it is for them. Your honest experience using this product is more useful to viewers than a promotional framing. If there are conditions or skin types where it performs better or worse, that is exactly the kind of detail we want.

Variant B (on-brand)

This is a product that gets a lot of attention, mostly without explanation. We want you to be the explanation. In 60 seconds: what snail mucin does, what the COSRX formula does specifically, and what a first-time user should know about texture and layering. If you have used it long enough to have a real view on how it performs across different humidity levels or seasonal skin changes, that kind of depth is what our audience responds to. The brief is education. We want a viewer to finish knowing whether this product belongs in their routine.

Variant C (on-brand)

Brief for Jasmine K: COSRX Snail Mucin Essence, 60 seconds.

Cover what snail mucin actually is, not the trend, the mechanism. What does it do that makes it useful? Then apply that to the COSRX formula specifically: concentration, texture, how it behaves on skin in the 30 seconds after application, not just the moment of layering. Real-wear demonstration is ideal. The brief is education, not promotion. If you would frame this differently given your experience with the product, come back to us and we will talk through it.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

Hey Jasmine! We would love to collab on a super viral COSRX content piece! Just hype it up, show how amazing it is, and make sure to use #SimplexityBeauty and #COSRX. Feel free to use any claims that resonate with your audience. We are looking for max engagement so please post at peak hours and use popular audio to get the algorithm going. So excited to work with you!

Rubric failures:

- Item 6 (Cluster 2: Creator credibility cue) – Score: 0. The brief treats the creator as a megaphone, not a credible educator. No reference to Jasmine’s expertise or why she is the right voice for this product.
 - Item 7 (Cluster 2: Product education visible) – Score: 0. No product information is given to the creator, which means no product education can reach the viewer. The brief instructs hype without substance.
 - Item 8 (Cluster 2: Recommendation basis clear) – Score: 0. “Feel free to use any claims that resonate” actively instructs the creator to make unverified claims, which creates liability and directly undermines proof discipline.
 - Item 9 (Cluster 2: No medical or clinical overreach) – Score: 0. “Any claims that resonate” is an open pathway for clinical overclaiming at the creator level.
 - Item 11 (Cluster 3: No avoid phrase) – Score: 0. “Super viral” and “hype it up” appear in the prohibited register.
 - Item 15 (Cluster 4: Tone direction matches surface) – Score: 0. A Simplex-ity creator brief should be specific, educational, and treat the creator as a peer expert. This reads as a generic influencer activation message from a brand that does not know what the product does.
-

13.4 Service reply

Brief: A response to a first-time customer whose order of a Beauty of Joseon Glow Serum (glass bottle) arrived cracked. The order was placed four days ago. She has contacted support. The response must own the failure, resolve it specifically, and not make her do the work.

Variant A (on-brand)

I am sorry the Glow Serum arrived like this. A cracked bottle is not acceptable and you should not have received it. I am sending a replacement to the same address now, no return needed. You will get a tracking number within 24 hours. If the delivery address has changed or you would prefer store credit instead, just reply here and I will sort it. This is not the start we wanted for you.

Variant B (on-brand)

That is not the experience we want anyone to have with their first order. A replacement is on its way. I will confirm tracking within one business day and you do not need to return the damaged bottle. If anything about the replacement address is different, or if you would rather have store credit toward your next order, reply to this message and I will make that change before it ships.

Variant C (on-brand)

A cracked bottle arriving from us is a packaging failure on our side. I am arranging a replacement of the Beauty of Joseon Glow Serum now. No return required. You will see tracking details within 24 hours. If you would prefer store credit or need it sent somewhere different, let me know here.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

Dear valued customer, we sincerely apologise for the inconvenience you have experienced with your recent order. We take quality very seriously and are sorry for any distress this may have caused. Please be assured that we are investigating the matter thoroughly. As per our returns policy, please submit a returns request within 14 days and our team will process your case in 5-7 business days. We appreciate your patience and your continued support as a valued member of the Simplex-ity community.

Rubric failures:

- Item 1 (Cluster 1: Trust leads) – Score: 0. The reply opens with a formal corporate apology and redirects the customer to a 14-day returns process. The first-time customer's experience is not owned and the problem is not resolved in the reply.
 - Item 15 (Cluster 4: Tone direction matches surface) – Score: 0. Service reply tone should be direct, warm, and resolution-first. "Valued customer", "any inconvenience", "we take quality very seriously" are corporate template language that the tone matrix explicitly marks as wrong register for this surface.
 - Item 17 (Cluster 4: Mandatory fields present) – Score: 0. The surface template requires honest acknowledgement and a clear, specific next step. This reply defers resolution to a separate 5-7 business day process and makes the customer submit a request, which reverses the ownership the brand should be taking.
 - Item 18 (Cluster 4: Surface-specific do-not-say respected) – Score: 0. "Valued member of the Simplex-ity community" and "we take quality very seriously" are hollow brand assertions the service reply template explicitly flags as wrong for any error state. The copy says the brand cares without doing anything that shows it.
-

13.5 Social (IG and TikTok)

Brief: IG caption and TikTok caption introducing the rom&nd Milk Tint to the Simplex-ity feed. The product is a sheer, milky lip tint that applies water-light and dries to a glossy stain finish. Six shades are available. The audience has likely seen the product mentioned; this copy is where they go to understand it before buying.

Variant A, IG (on-brand)

The Milk Tint from rom&nd is the sheer layer you put under everything else, or wear on its own when you want your lips to look like lips but better. Water-light texture. Slight gloss without stickiness. It builds if you want more coverage. Six shades in the current edit, all calibrated for how the milky finish reads on different natural lip depths.

Variant B, IG (on-brand)

rom&nd's formula here is worth understanding: the tint applies water-thin and sets into a sheer, glossy stain that stays put without feathering or transferring. It layers under a liner, over a balm, or on its own. We brought in six shades because the range matters for how a milky finish reads against different lip tones. Not all six work the same for everyone, which is why the individual shade notes are in the product page.

Variant A, TikTok (on-brand)

Why the rom&nd Milk Tint made the edit: the formula behaves differently to most tints. Water-texture going on, glossy stain result, zero stickiness. If someone told you lip tints do not work for you, show them this one.

Variant B, TikTok (on-brand)

The rom&nd Milk Tint in 20 seconds: water-light, dries glossy, no feathering, six shades. The milky finish reads differently on every lip tone, which is why we chose the specific six we have. Worth reading the shade notes before choosing.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

Caption used for diagnosis (IG format):

OBSESSED with this new drop!! The rom&nd Milk Tint is literally EVERYTHING we have been waiting for and the whole community is going crazy for it! It is giving gorgeous dewy glow vibes and we are living for the way it looks. Do not sleep on this one, it is already going viral and selling out FAST! Link in bio to shop before it is gone! #romand #kbeauty #milkint #viral #trending #glowup #liptint #musthave

Rubric failures:

- Item 1 (Cluster 1: Trust leads) – Score: 0. “OBSESSED” and “literally EVERYTHING we have been waiting for” open with excitement. No trust signal or product information appears first.
- Item 7 (Cluster 2: Product education visible) – Score: 0. Nothing about how the product applies, finishes, or performs is communicated. The caption tells the audience how excited to be, not what the product does.

- Item 11 (Cluster 3: No avoid phrase) – Score: 0. “Viral”, “trending”, “glow up”, “must-have”, and “selling out FAST” all appear in the prohibited register.
- Item 13 (Cluster 3: No slang or trend language) – Score: 0. “Literally EVERYTHING”, “we are living for”, “do not sleep on this” are brand-register violations for the editorial social voice.
- Item 15 (Cluster 4: Tone direction matches surface) – Score: 0. The social tone anchor is specific and editorial. This caption reads as a generic beauty influencer post calibrated for algorithmic reach rather than genuine recommendation.
- Item 25 (Cluster 6: Copy reads selective) – Score: 0. Eight competing claims and eight hashtags in one caption. It reads as noise, not a curated edit.

13.6 Email (subject line and body)

Brief: A newsletter introducing a new curated “edit” of three cushion foundations selected specifically for deeper skin tones: TIRTIR Mask Fit Red Cushion, Laneige Neo Cushion Matte, and rom&nd Zero Cushion. The selection rationale is that most cushion foundations underserve medium-to-deep skin; these three each solve the problem in a different way.

Variant A (on-brand)

Subject: The three cushion foundations we chose for deeper skin tones, and why.

Body: Most cushion foundations are calibrated for pale skin. We noticed. This month’s edit addresses that directly: three cushion foundations that were either built with deeper shades as a core commitment, or extended their range in a way that did not just add token dark options.

The TIRTIR Mask Fit has 45 shades. The deeper range was developed with the same formula attention as the core. The Laneige Neo Cushion Matte performs best in the medium-to-deep range and handles humidity without slipping. The rom&nd Zero Cushion covers the full range without oxidising noticeably on deeper skin, which is where most other cushions lose the finish.

Three products. Three different finishes. All chosen because they earn their place in a routine where shade range is the baseline expectation, not a bonus.

Variant B (on-brand)

Subject: The cushion foundation edit: three products that actually cover the full range.

Body: We have been testing this three-cushion edit across different skin tones for the last month. The conclusion is the same each time: there is a version of the cushion finish that works for deeper skin. It is just not always easy to find, which is why we did the work.

TIRTIR, Laneige, and rom&nd each approached the shade problem differently. TIRTIR built 45 shades from the start. Laneige calibrated its formula specifically for medium-to-deep wear. rom&nd focused on finish stability, which matters more as skin depth increases and most formulas start to oxidise. We picked these three because they represent three distinct solutions to the same gap in the category.

Variant C (on-brand)

Subject: Three cushion foundations selected for where the category usually fails.

Body: We have been using this cushion edit for the last month, and honestly it replaces the 20-minute foundation process that no one has time for.

Three products: TIRTIR Mask Fit for coverage that does not look like coverage. Laneige Neo Cushion Matte for the medium-to-deep range where most cushions give up on the finish. rom&nd Zero Cushion for days when the air is warm and everything else oxidises by noon. Each one was chosen because it solves a specific problem for deeper skin tones. The combined edit is a 90-second routine.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

Subject: HUGE SALE on K-beauty cushions – 20% off for the next 24 hours only!

Body: Hey beauty lovers! Do not miss out on our biggest beauty sale of the month! We have got amazing deals on all your favourite cushion foundations from the hottest K-beauty brands. These are flying off the shelves so act now before they are all gone. Our AI-powered personalisation will match you with the perfect shade! Use code GLOWUP20 at checkout. This is the glow up you have been waiting for!

Rubric failures:

- Item 1 (Cluster 1: Trust leads) – Score: 0. The subject line leads with a price promotion. Discount-first framing signals marketplace energy before any product or trust information.
 - Item 7 (Cluster 2: Product education visible) – Score: 0. No product information is provided. The email is entirely promotional framing with no educational content about the products being sold.
 - Item 11 (Cluster 3: No avoid phrase) – Score: 0. “Biggest beauty sale”, “do not miss out”, “act now”, “glow up”, “hottest”, and “flying off the shelves” all appear in the prohibited register.
 - Item 13 (Cluster 3: No slang or trend language) – Score: 0. “Beauty lovers”, “glow up” appear as brand-register violations.
 - Item 15 (Cluster 4: Tone direction matches surface) – Score: 0. Email tone should be conversational and curated, explaining why products were selected. This reads as a mass-market promotional email from a discount retailer.
 - Item 22 (Cluster 5: No AI claim without active feature) – Score: 0. “AI-powered personalisation will match you with the perfect shade” claims a specific active feature. If this feature does not exist in phase 1, this is a false proof claim and must not appear.
-

13.7 Error and empty states

Brief: Three UI states: (1) empty cart, (2) failed search with no results for the query “purple eyeshadow”, (3) an out-of-stock notice on a COSRX Centella Blemish Cream. Each state should maintain the brand’s calm, helpful tone while keeping the user oriented and moving toward a next step. All states should be under 20 words.

Variant A (on-brand)

Empty cart: Your cart is empty. Browse the current edit or search for something specific.

Failed search: Nothing matched “purple eyeshadow.” Try a finish, a texture, or a brand name instead.

Out of stock: This COSRX Centella Cream is out of stock right now. Enter your email and we will let you know when it is back.

Variant B (on-brand)

Empty cart: Nothing here yet. Start with a look or explore the current edit.

Failed search: No results for “purple eyeshadow.” Try searching by finish, texture, or brand.

Out of stock: Out of stock. We will notify you when this one is back.

Variant C (on-brand)

Empty cart: Your cart is empty. The edit is a good place to start.

Failed search: “Purple eyeshadow” did not return results. Try a finish type or brand name.

Out of stock: Not available right now. Sign up and we will contact you when it is back in stock.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

Empty cart: Oops! Your cart looks a bit lonely! Time for a glow up! Add some of our amazing must-have products and treat yourself!

Failed search: Oh no, we could not find “purple eyeshadow”! Do not worry though, our AI is super smart and working hard to find you the best products! Check out our trending page instead!

Out of stock: This product is SO popular it is practically sold out everywhere! Do not miss out. Sign up to be first in line when it is back, limited quantities only!

Rubric failures:

- Item 15 (Cluster 4: Tone direction matches surface) – Score: 0. Error and empty state tone must be calm, direct, and action-oriented. “Oops!”, “your cart looks a bit lonely”, and “Oh no” are false cheer in a context where the user needs orientation, not enthusiasm.
- Item 11 (Cluster 3: No avoid phrase) – Score: 0. “Glow up”, “must-have”, “trending”, and “do not miss out” all appear in the prohibited register.
- Item 16 (Cluster 4: Copy length within range) – Score: 0. Error states are specified at 5-20 words. “Do not worry though, our AI is super smart and working hard to find you the best products!” is 21 words and padded beyond its purpose.
- Item 18 (Cluster 4: Surface-specific do-not-say respected) – Score: 0. “Oops!” is explicitly named as a do-not-say for error states in the surface 7 template. “Do not miss out” and scarcity language are also prohibited in this context.
- Item 22 (Cluster 5: No AI claim without active feature) – Score: 0. “Our AI is super smart and working hard to find you the best products” claims an active AI discovery capability.

- Item 17 (Cluster 4: Mandatory fields present) – Score: 0. The out-of-stock state implies manufactured scarcity (“SO popular it is practically sold out everywhere”) rather than providing a plain, honest next step. The mandatory field is a clear action, not a pressure tactic.
-

13.8 Investor-facing

Brief: A 75-word paragraph for a pitch deck slide introducing Simplex-ity’s business model to potential investors. The paragraph should communicate what the business is, what phase 1 is proving, and why the model is worth backing, with commercially specific language and no lifestyle or beauty-editorial tone.

Variant A (on-brand)

Simplex-ity is a curated Asian beauty retailer built for Western-market consumers, specifically Asian consumers raised outside Asia, who find mainstream local retail incomplete for their skin tones, features, and cultural beauty references. Phase 1 validates the trust and conversion model through a makeup-led, curated assortment with creator-guided discovery before category or geographic expansion. Proof conditions: trusted sourcing operations, credible creator partner traction, and repeatable demand from a high-intent consumer segment.

Variant B (on-brand)

The Western-market Asian beauty category is underserved at the trusted-retail layer. Consumers who discover through Asian beauty content have no equivalent high-trust destination for the purchase decision. Simplex-ity builds that destination: curated assortment, creator-guided education, and a commerce design built around the trust signals this segment requires. Phase 1 is a disciplined proof of the model, not a platform play. Proof conditions: sourcing integrity, creator partner traction, and conversion metrics that justify category expansion.

Variant C (on-brand)

Asian beauty spending in North America is growing, primarily through discovery routes that consistently outpace the trusted retail infrastructure serving that discovery. Simplex-ity’s phase 1 builds the retail infrastructure: curated assortment calibrated for Western-market Asian consumers, creator-led education that converts intent to purchase, and a commerce experience designed around trust rather than breadth. Phase 1 exit: proof of unit economics, repeat purchase rate, and a replicable sourcing model.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

Simplex-ity is revolutionizing the 50-billion-dollar Asian beauty market with our game-changing AI-powered beauty discovery platform! We are disrupting the industry by combining cutting-edge technology with the hottest K-beauty trends to create an unparalleled one-stop-shop experience. Our innovative platform will transform how people discover and buy beauty products globally. This is a once-in-a-generation opportunity to get in on the future of beauty retail!

Rubric failures:

- Item 1 (Cluster 1: Trust leads) – Score: 0. The copy opens with scale hype and market-size framing. No trust signal, business discipline, or commercial specificity is communicated before the excitement claim.
 - Item 4 (Cluster 1: Technology supporting) – Score: 0. “AI-powered beauty discovery platform” is the primary business description. Technology is framing the brand before any trust or curation model is mentioned.
 - Item 11 (Cluster 3: No avoid phrase) – Score: 0. “Revolutionizing”, “game-changing”, “disrupting”, “cutting-edge”, and “one-stop-shop” all appear in the prohibited register.
 - Item 15 (Cluster 4: Tone direction matches surface) – Score: 0. Investor copy must be data-anchored, commercially specific, and proof-oriented. This reads as a crowdfunding pitch. Investors reading this copy will evaluate the team’s judgment as credibility-poor, not just the copy as enthusiasm-forward.
 - Item 19 (Cluster 5: No unconfirmed claim beyond phase 1) – Score: 0. “Transform how people discover and buy beauty products globally” implies a scope and timeline well beyond the confirmed phase 1 model. This is an authorization claim the brand cannot back.
 - Item 22 (Cluster 5: No AI claim without active feature) – Score: 0. “AI-powered beauty discovery platform” as the lead business description claims an active AI system as the core product. If this feature does not exist in phase 1, this is a misleading investor statement.
-

13.9 Partner-facing (brand outreach)

Brief: An outreach message to Peach and Lily, a Korean American beauty brand, about a potential wholesale or consignment arrangement. Simplex-ity is approaching them selectively because the Glass Skin range has proven credibility with the Western-market Asian consumer segment. The message should signal discernment, not desperation.

Variant A (on-brand)

Hi Peach and Lily team, I am Jenny from Simplex-ity. We are building a curated Asian beauty retail destination for Western-market consumers, specifically the Asian diaspora segment that mainstream retail consistently underserves. We are approaching brands selectively, and Peach and Lily made the shortlist because the Glass Skin range has a specific credibility with the audience we serve that goes beyond trend awareness. There is a depth of understanding in how it is formulated and positioned that aligns with what our customers look for. We would like to explore whether a wholesale or consignment arrangement makes sense. Would you be open to a brief conversation?

Variant B (on-brand)

Hi, I am reaching out from Simplex-ity. We are a curated Asian beauty retailer focused on a specific consumer: Asian consumers in Western markets who want products calibrated for their skin tones and routines, buying through trusted guidance rather than algorithmic discovery.

Peach and Lily is on our shortlist because the Glass Skin line performs well with exactly that consumer, and because the brand’s education approach matches what our creators do: explain the mechanism, not just the result. I would welcome a 20-minute conversation to see whether our commercial models are compatible.

Variant C (on-brand)

Simplex-ity is a curated Asian beauty retail destination built around editorial curation, creator-guided education, and a commerce experience designed around trust. We are in phase 1, selective about which brands we carry, and focused on Western-market Asian consumers.

We are interested in Peach and Lily because the Glass Skin range has a track record of working with the skin tones and concerns our customer base brings to the purchase decision. If a commercial arrangement makes sense for both sides, we would like to find out. Open to a brief conversation if you are.

Variant D (off-brand) – Rubric diagnosis

Hey Peach and Lily! We would absolutely LOVE to partner with you! Our platform is huge and has amazing reach with beauty lovers everywhere. Partnering with us is a massive opportunity to grow your brand and get your products in front of our enormous community of beauty fanatics. We offer unbeatable exposure and our AI personalisation will match your products to the perfect audience! Do not miss out on this huge opportunity to join the Simplex-ity family!

Rubric failures:

- Item 8 (Cluster 2: Recommendation basis clear) – Score: 0. No specific reason is given for why Peach and Lily was chosen. “We would absolutely LOVE to partner with you” is the exact generic flattery the partner-facing surface template explicitly marks as a do-not-say.
- Item 11 (Cluster 3: No avoid phrase) – Score: 0. “Unbeatable exposure”, “massive opportunity”, and “do not miss out” all appear in the prohibited register.
- Item 15 (Cluster 4: Tone direction matches surface) – Score: 0. Partner outreach should be peer-toned, specific, and credibility-signalling. “Hey!”, “beauty fanatics”, and “the Simplex-ity family” are register violations that signal the brand is more excited about the partnership than prepared for it.
- Item 17 (Cluster 4: Mandatory fields present) – Score: 0. The surface template requires: brand description (one sentence), specific fit reason, what partnership involves, and a clear next step. Specific fit reason and what partnership involves are both absent. Three of four mandatory fields are missing or replaced with hype.
- Item 19 (Cluster 5: No unconfirmed claim) – Score: 0. “Our platform is huge” and “enormous community of beauty fanatics” claim scale and audience size without any specified or verified basis. In a partner outreach context, this reads as either vague or misleading.
- Item 22 (Cluster 5: No AI claim without active feature) – Score: 0. “Our AI personalisation will match your products to the perfect audience” claims a specific active AI capability as a commercial pitch point. If the feature does not exist, this is a false representation to a commercial partner.

Section 14: Governance

This section defines who owns what in the brand playbook, how changes are processed, and when the document should be reviewed. It uses the BX-01 ownership tier convention (H1 through H4) established in the project backlog.

14.1 Ownership by role

Four ownership tiers apply to this playbook. Each tier has a defined scope. Changes outside a tier’s scope must escalate upward.

Tier	Role	Playbook responsibilities
H1	QA and asset organisation	Runs the 25-item Brand Self-Check Rubric (Section 12.5) against AI-generated copy before it is used in any production context. Maintains the asset library (logo files, approved photography, type specimens). Flags rubric failures for H3 review. Does not change playbook content.
H2	Template and front-end implementation	Works closest to this document when building site components, CMS templates, and email layouts. Responsible for translating playbook direction into implementation decisions. Surfaces ambiguities in the visual system or copy rules to H3 when the playbook does not clearly resolve them.
H3	Jenny Au / Wilson T	Owns the playbook’s accuracy day to day. Processes change requests from H1 and H2. Approves minor edits (typographical corrections, updated examples, non-strategic glossary additions). Escalates major edits to H4. Maintains Section 16.1 (change log).
H4	Kieran (Simplex-ity Founder and CEO)	Final approver for any change to: strategic anchor, brand idea and positioning, brand personality and voice principles, non-negotiables, visual system (palette, typography, logo). Also approves resolution of any watch-out listed in Section 16.3.

14.2 Change control

Minor edits (H3 authority): Typographical corrections, updated or added worked examples, clarifications to existing rules that do not change the substance of the rule, and glossary additions for operational terms. H3 approves and logs in Section 16.1.

Major edits (H4 authority): Any change to the strategic anchor, brand idea, positioning statement, voice principles, personality descriptors, the do-not-say register at a category level, the visual system, or the scope and direction of Section 12 (AI operating system). H4 approval required before changes take effect. H3 logs in Section 16.1 after approval.

Emergency changes: If an operational event requires immediate copy guidance outside this playbook (crisis response, regulatory instruction, launch announcement not covered by existing templates), H3 drafts temporary guidance and flags for H4 ratification within 48 hours. Temporary guidance is not a playbook change until ratified.

Rejected change requests: If H3 declines a change request from H1 or H2, the reasoning is documented in Section 16.1. If H2 or H1 disagrees with H3's decision, they escalate to H4 directly.

14.3 Review cadence

Quarterly review (scheduled): H3 reviews the playbook against current output to check for drift, emerging language patterns not covered by the rules, and any changes in operational proof that affect claims in Sections 8 and 9. Review findings go to H4 with a summary of recommended changes.

Ad hoc review triggers: The following events trigger an unscheduled review regardless of cadence:

- Kieran completes any of the founder items listed in Section 16.2. These directly gate a v1.1 revision.
- A new surface (channel, market, or audience segment) is added that is not covered by the 9-surface templates in Section 12.2.
- The platform expands into a new geographic market, changing the audience parameters in Section 3.
- A creator, brand, or technology partnership changes the proof basis for claims in Section 9.
- Legal, regulatory, or consumer protection guidance changes what can be claimed in the beauty category in the markets Simplex-ity operates in.

Version release: A new version number is issued when major edits are approved by H4. Minor edits accumulate within the current version and are logged in Section 16.1 without triggering a version increment. The version history is maintained in Section 16.1.

Section 15: Glossary

Terms used throughout this playbook, defined for consistent understanding across internal team, creator partners, and AI tools. Definitions are utility-first. Where a term has a specific brand meaning that differs from its general usage, that distinction is noted.

Asian beauty The category of beauty products, brands, and routines originating from East and Southeast Asia, primarily Korea, Japan, and China. In the Simplex-ity context, Asian beauty refers to the curated product assortment, not a demographic label. See also: K-beauty.

K-beauty Korean beauty. A sub-category within Asian beauty, the primary product origin in the Simplex-ity assortment. In copy, K-beauty is acceptable as a category shorthand when the products being referenced are specifically Korean. Do not use K-beauty as a synonym for all Asian beauty.

Creator A content creator who produces educational beauty content and whose audience trusts their product recommendations. In the Simplex-ity context, creator specifically means an educator, not a promoter. The distinction matters for brief-writing, copy attribution, and imagery direction. “Influencer” is not used internally as a substitute for creator; see the do-not-say register in Section 12.4.

Edit / curated edit A selected group of products chosen for a specific purpose, audience need, or defining characteristic. An edit implies intent behind the selection. Using “edit” in copy commits the brand to explaining why these products made it in. Never use “edit” if the selection rationale is not clear or defensible.

Curation The act of selecting products with intent and discipline, as opposed to stocking by algorithm, trend, or breadth. Curation is a brand claim that must be backed by visible selection rationale. If copy claims curation, the editorial basis should be apparent in the surrounding copy or context.

PDP (Product Detail Page) The product page on the Simplex-ity site where a specific product is described, contextualised, and sold. PDP copy is the primary surface for product education. It is held to the highest standard for specificity, accuracy, and proof discipline.

Trust signal A specific element in copy or design that actively builds the reader’s confidence in the brand or in a specific claim being made. Examples: naming the creator who recommended a product and why, explaining the selection rationale for an edit, showing the shade range rather than just claiming inclusivity. A trust signal is specific. A vague reassurance (“we care about quality”) is not a trust signal.

Proof point A factual, verifiable claim that supports the brand’s positioning. Proof points must be operationally backed. A claim that cannot be verified today is an aspiration, not a proof point, and should not appear in consumer-facing copy. See Section 9 for the proof discipline framework.

JTBD (Jobs to be Done) A framework for describing what a consumer is trying to accomplish when they engage with the brand or a product. Simplex-ity’s five consumer JTBDs are documented in Section 3. JTBDs inform copy hierarchy and surface priorities.

Register The level and style of language appropriate to a specific surface or audience. The Simplex-ity register is warm and considered by default, with variation by surface (more spare for error states, more commercially specific for investor copy). See Section 7 (language register) and Section 6 (tone by surface).

Surface A channel or context in which brand copy appears. The nine surfaces covered by this playbook are: homepage, PDP, creator brief, service reply, social (IG and TikTok), email, error and empty states, investor-facing, and partner-facing. Each surface has a defined tone direction and templates in Section 12.2.

Lean-into list The approved vocabulary in Section 7 – words and phrases the brand actively uses in copy. Using at least one lean-into word or phrase per piece of copy is a rubric requirement (item 10).

Avoid list The prohibited vocabulary in Section 7. No word or phrase from this list should appear in brand copy. A more extensive machine-parsable version is the do-not-say register in Section 12.4.

Do-not-say register The full 54-entry YAML list of prohibited phrases in Section 12.4, organised by category (hype, discount, false_tech, false_community, overclaim, medical_clinical, scarcity_urgency, generic_beauty). Load alongside the master system-prompt block when using AI tools to generate Simplex-ity copy.

Brand self-check rubric The 25-item scoring framework in Section 12.5. Used to evaluate any piece of copy before it is published or returned from an AI tool. Items score 0 (fail), 1 (partial), or 2 (pass). Minimum acceptable score per item is 1. Any item scoring 0 requires revision before use.

Source document A primary input document used in building this playbook.0: (founder ambition and non-negotiables), (brand naming and tone guardrails, primary verbal identity source), (positioning memo and messaging architecture). Source provenance is labelled throughout the document.

H1 / H2 / H3 / H4 The ownership tier convention used in the BX-01 backlog and in Section 14. H1 = QA and asset organisation. H2 = template and front-end implementation. H3 = task lead. H4 = Kieran (founder and final approver). See Section 14.1 for full role descriptions.

Watch-out A specific tension between the current brand assets and the brand direction, flagged for founder review. Five watch-outs apply to v1.0 of this playbook. All five are consolidated in Section 16.3. None requires an immediate redesign decision; all require a decision before the next brand evolution.

Western-market consumer The core Simplex-ity audience: a consumer based in North America or a comparable Western market. Distinct from a consumer in an Asian domestic market, who has easier access to Asian beauty through local retail. The specific sub-segment is the Asian diaspora consumer raised in a Western market who finds mainstream local retail incomplete for her skin tones, features, and cultural beauty references. See Section 3.

v1.1 gate The set of decisions that must be made before a significant revision of this playbook is warranted. Primary gates: completion of the founder items listed in Section 16.2, and operational proof of key claims in Section 9. Section 16.2 tracks the status of each gate.

System prompt / master prompt block The copy-pasteable text block in Section 12.1. Load this at the start of any AI session producing Simplex-ity copy. It contains the full brand operating context in an order and format that AI tools can directly ingest and apply.

Section 16: Change log and open items

16.1 Change log

Version	Date	Change	Approved by
v1.0	2026-04-21	Initial publication. Consolidates verbal identity, positioning, and AI operating system into a single source of truth. Retires Simplexity_Brand_Guidelines.pdf as the brand book of record. Adds: AI operating system (Section 12), worked examples library (Section 13), governance (Section 14), glossary (Section 15).	Jenny Au

Minor edits to v1.0 will be logged here as they occur without a version number increment. Major edits approved by H4 will increment the version number.

16.2 Watch-outs for Founder Review

Five tensions exist between the current brand assets and the brand direction. None requires an immediate redesign decision. Items marked **Decide before launch** require Kieran's input before launch copy locks. All others can be deferred to the next brand evolution.

Watch-out 1: Typeface heritage vs. brand direction [Decide at next brand evolution](#)

Exo is a geometric typeface built for technology brands. The Simplex-ity brand direction is editorial, calm, and premium. These pull against each other. Exo is preserved as the current identity typeface and the usage rules in Section 11.2 reduce the tension. At the next brand evolution, evaluate whether a more humanist or beauty-heritage typeface better serves the positioning.

Watch-out 2: Colour palette reads consumer software more than beauty editorial [Decide at next brand evolution](#)

The primary lilac [#8c82fc](#) is visually associated with consumer software products rather than premium beauty. The three usage disciplines in Section 11.1 (white leads the page, purple as signature, photography carries warmth) manage this within the current palette. If the tech-adjacent read creates confusion at scale, a palette evolution should be considered with H4 approval.

Watch-out 3: Logo text conflicts with the brand positioning [Decide before launch](#)

The current logo includes the line “One Stop Asian Beauty – Simplify to Amplify.” The brand idea in Section 4 is “Asian beauty, made easier to trust, learn, and love.” The two express different intentions and are not compatible as co-equal brand statements. “One Stop” also directly contradicts the curation positioning and the prohibited phrases

in Section 12.4. Kieran to decide: keep the logo text as-is, revise it to align with the brand idea, or remove it. Until that decision is made, do not use the logo text in any brand copy or campaign material.

Watch-out 4: Pitch deck imagery conflicts with the visual direction [Decide before launch](#)

The April 2026 pitch deck (pages 1 and 15) features AI-generated female portraits and floating tech-UI overlays. These are anti-patterns under Section 11.4: they risk reading as artificial to consumers, and they reflect a tech-platform aesthetic the brand has moved away from. Those images should not appear on any consumer-facing surface. The product flat-lay on pitch deck page 8 is reusable and is the correct photography reference. Kieran to confirm these visuals will not be carried into future brand or investor materials.

Watch-out 5: founder items remain open [Track in project RAID log, not in this document](#)

Several founding ambition items are pending Kieran's completion and touch brand language directly (creator storefronts scope, virtual try-on role, 12-month business posture, founder success threshold). These are tracked in the project RAID log. When the founding ambition document is finalised, review Sections 2, 4, 8, 9, and 12 of this playbook for required updates.
